

GALATIANS

2nd Edition



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as Galatians, second edition

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Course Introduction

DESCRIPTION OF THE COURSE

In this course you will study Paul's letter to the Galatians. You will look at its background and examine the vital theological issues dealt in the early church. You will become better acquainted with the life, character, and ministry of the apostle Paul. You will also gain new insights into Christian life and service as you apply the teaching of this epistle to contemporary situations.

OBJECTIVES OF THE COURSE

All of the BEE courses are based on the conviction that every Christian has a ministry. God has a purpose for your life and ministry. This course has been written to help you incorporate the great truths revealed in Galatians into your own life and service for Christ. When you finish this course you should be able to:

1. Appreciate the up-to-date solutions that God supplies in this letter containing concerns that the Christian faces today: apply them as needed in your life and ministry.
2. Appreciate more deeply the life, character, and ministry of the apostle Paul and apply the principles that will improve your own life and service.
3. Discuss these aspects of the background of the Galatian epistle: the date of writing, the occasion for writing, and the recipients of this letter.
4. Explain and trace the development of Paul's teaching on faith throughout this epistle.

Foreword

“The righteous shall live by faith” (Galatians 3:11). The emphasis Martin Luther placed on this truth in the sixteenth century resulted in the Protestant Reformation. This doctrine of justification by faith brought new life into the Church and became one of the central teachings of the evangelical churches. An understanding of this all-important biblical concept will result in a deeper appreciation of the grace of God as it has come to us in the Lord Jesus Christ. Our study will take us through the book of Galatians which deals in detail with this fundamental doctrine.

From its earliest days the Christian Church has raised questions concerning the relationship between law and grace. What was the purpose of the giving of the law in the Old Testament? Were godly people in Old Testament times saved by obeying the law? Does the plan of salvation in the New Testament differ from that in the Old Testament? Is a person saved by faith alone? Or is it a matter of faith plus work? Does the New Testament really teach that salvation must come through Jesus Christ alone? If a person is saved by faith alone does it make no difference what kind of life he lives? Why was it necessary for the Son of God to die on the cross in order to provide salvation for mankind? Paul deals with all these crucial questions in Galatians.

Matters of theology must always be examined in the light of the Scriptures. It is with this in mind that we approach our study of Paul's letter to the Galatians. We will do it reverently because these are part of God's Word. We will do it prayerfully because we need the guidance of the Holy Spirit who inspired it through the apostle. We will do it carefully and analytically because we need to love the Lord our God not only with our hearts but also with our minds (Matthew 22:37). We will do it gratefully because we have already experienced God's grace and are now given an opportunity to understand it better.

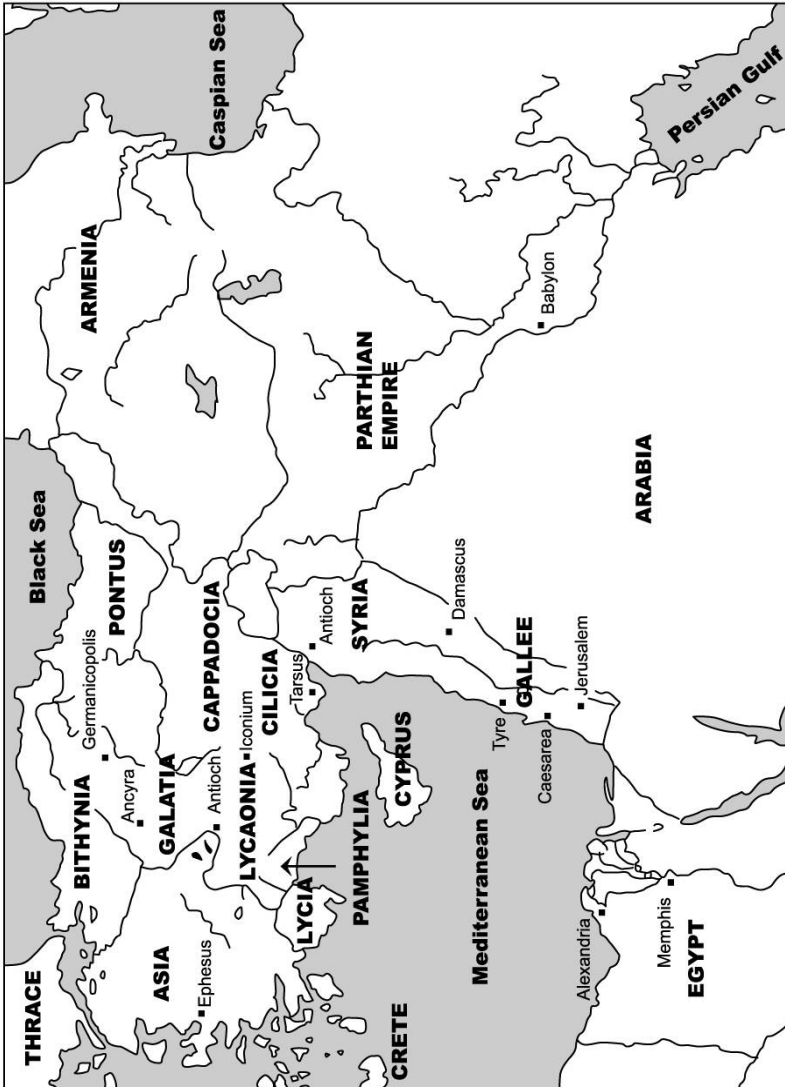
Our aim for this study goes beyond understanding the doctrines in Galatians. We also have a practical aim. Paul intentionally wrote this letter with both doctrinal and practical divisions. He wants his audience to know that the righteousness of God received by faith is related to conduct. Paul was more than a theologian; he related what he believed

and taught about God to real life. For him doctrine and practice were inseparable.

The faith that obtains the righteousness of God is to issue forth in living faith. The initial act of faith is to give birth to a living faith. The word living here is not only living which is the opposite of dead but also faith which is at work in life. It is a faith for living day by day—not just the single act which brings right standing with God but also the continuous trust in and response to God.

Perhaps you have heard the saying, “the only gospel some people ever read is your life.” As the key verse above states, in the gospel the righteousness of God is revealed by faith. It also means that the righteousness of God is revealed in you as you live by faith from day to day. This is our practical aim for you in this study.

Maps



Map 1. Galatia and the Roman Empire



Map 2. Paul's First Missionary Journey



Map 3. Paul's Second Missionary Journey



Map 4. Paul's Third Missionary Journey

Pauline Chronology Chart

Places and Events	AD	Journeys and Epistles
Conversion – near Damascus (Acts 9)	31/32	
Visit to Arabia (Galatians 1:17)	33-36	
First Visit to Jerusalem (Acts 9:26)	37	
Second Visit to Jerusalem Famine Visit (Acts 11:30)	45	
	45-49	First Missionary Journey (Acts 13:4)
	49	Galatians
Third Visit to Jerusalem Council Visit (Acts 15:2-4)	49/50	
	50-53	Second Missionary Journey (Acts 15:40)
	52/53	1 Thessalonians 2 Thessalonians
Fourth Visit to Jerusalem (Acts 18:21-22)	53	
	54-58	Third Missionary Journey (Acts 18:23)
	57	1 Corinthians 2 Corinthians Romans
Arrest in Jerusalem (Acts 21:30-34)	58	
Imprisonment at Caesarea (Acts 23:23-33)	58-60	
First Imprisonment in Rome (Acts 28:16)	60-63	
	62	Colossians Ephesians Philemon
	63	Philippians
Release from Imprisonment	63-67	Further Travels
	67	1 Timothy Titus
Second Imprisonment in Rome	68	2 Timothy
Martyrdom	68	

Dates are approximate. The purpose of the chart is to give the student an overview of Paul's post-conversion life. We will examine the facts more closely in the study of Galatians 1:13-16. The date given for the writing of Galatians is based on the assumption that it was written close to the time of the Jerusalem Council—possibly just prior to it.

Unit I

Paul: Defender of the Faith

- 1. Preparation of the Defender**
- 2. Preparation of the Defense**

Lesson 1

Preparation of the Defender

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. Defender of the Jewish Faith
 - 1. Education
 - 2. Experience
- B. Conversion to Christ
 - 1. Factors Influencing Paul's Conversion
 - 2. Conversion
- C. Apostle of Christ

LESSON OBJECTIVES

1. State how Paul's training and experience in Judaism helped prepare him to proclaim and defend the gospel.
2. Identify many of the personal characteristics of Paul as you teach or preach from the book of Acts and explain how God used these in his ministry.
3. Identify in the Book of Acts the influences that led to Paul's conversion and consider the importance of such influences on the enemies of Christ today.
4. Demonstrate an understanding of Paul's character, ministry, and writings.

WORD STUDY

- *Apostle* — one who is sent, missionary. Apostle comes from the Greek and missionary from Latin but both originally meant the same thing. We think of an apostle as being ordained of God for an important mission, a person of great spiritual power and effectiveness, who takes the gospel into new fields.

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- *Faith* — trust; belief in God, religion, or spiritual things; what is believed. The faith that Paul defended first was the Old Testament teachings and the religious traditions of the Jews. Later he defended the Christian faith against false doctrine.
- *Gentile* — person who is not a Jew. The Galatian churches were made up of Gentile believers and some Jewish Christians.
- *Gospel* — good news; the teachings of Jesus and the apostles; the basic truths about salvation through faith in Jesus Christ.
- *Messiah* — the anointed one. In Old Testament times, prophets, priests, and kings were anointed with oil (oil was poured on the head) to set them apart officially for God and his work. The prophets wrote about a coming Savior who would be prophet, priest, and king. God would anoint him with the Holy Spirit, giving him the authority and power to carry out his mission. He was the Messiah—the anointed one—who would bring a solution to the world's problems and establish a kingdom of universal peace, justice, and prosperity. Messiah is the Hebrew and Christos the Greek word for anointed one. When we call Jesus Christ, we are really referring to his official position as the one God has anointed to be our Prophet, Priest, and King.
- *Theology* — study of the nature of God and his relations to man and the universe; system of religious beliefs. Saul's theological training was in the Old Testament Scriptures. The Old Testament reveals the nature of God and gives us the history of his relations to man and the universe up until the coming of Christ. Paul's epistles are a clear presentation of Christian theology.

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

The more you know about an author, the better you understand his writings. Before you start to study Galatians, let's look at the person who wrote this epistle—the great apostle Paul. The more you know about his personal characteristics and experiences, the more clearly you will see why he wrote what he did. Throughout Galatians, we will see Paul defending the Christian faith against the Judaizers. You have already read about the importance of this epistle. Now let's see how God prepared Paul through education and experience to write it.

A. Defender of the Jewish Faith

Objective 1: State how Paul's training and experience in Judaism helped prepare him to proclaim and defend the gospel.

1. Education

Read Acts 22:3 and answer the following questions:

Question 1: Name the city and province where Paul was born.

Question 2: Who taught theology to Paul?

Question 3: Paul says he was educated according to _____.

Question 4: How did Paul's thorough training in the Scriptures prepare him to understand the truths of the gospel and teach them to others?

- a) He was able to preach Christ from the Old Testament prophecies.
- b) He could understand the relationship between the law and the gospel of salvation through faith in Jesus Christ.
- c) God used Saul's brilliant mind and good education in the spread of the gospel, the defense of the faith, and the formulation of Christian doctrine
- d) All of the above

Paul, a brilliant young Jew from the city of Tarsus, was thoroughly schooled in the Old Testament Scriptures. When we first meet him, he is called by his Jewish name, Saul. He received his theological training at Jerusalem under one of the greatest teachers of that period—Gamaliel.

2. Experience

Objective 2: Identify many of the personal characteristics of Paul as you teach or preach from the book of Acts and explain how God used these in his ministry.

Question 5: Place a ✓ beside the words that describe Saul of Tarsus.

- | | | |
|---|--|--|
| ☐ educated | ☐ uneducated | ☐ intelligent |
| ☐ atheist | ☐ religious | ☐ Sadducee |
| ☐ Gentile | ☐ Pharisee | ☐ Christian |
| ☐ Jew | ☐ lazy | ☐ energetic |
| ☐ bold | ☐ timid | ☐ violent |
| ☐ loving | ☐ kind | ☐ strict |
| ☐ missionary | ☐ thorough | ☐ determined |
| ☐ heretic | ☐ sincere | ☐ influential |
| ☐ dedicated | ☐ independent | ☐ in organization |
| ☐ indifferent to the law | ☐ zealous for the law | |

Question 6: Go back to question 5 and write “P” for preparation beside any characteristic of Paul's that in any way was preparing him for his part in God's plan.

Question 7: Do you know anyone who was an enemy of Christ before one's conversion? If possible, talk with the person about the person's conversion. In what ways does his/her former experience help the person to understand and meet opposition now? What led to the conversion? List the names of any enemies of the gospel, either groups or individuals, and let us pray for them right now. Keep praying for them till they come to know and accept Jesus.

B. Conversion to Christ

Objective 3: Identify in the Book of Acts the influences that led to Paul's conversion and consider the importance of such influences on the enemies of Christ today.

1. Factors Influencing Paul's Conversion

Let's look for some of the influences that may have contributed to Saul's conversion. Read the passages in the book of Acts 5:12-39 and answer the questions.

Question 8: What did the members of the Jewish council want to do to the apostles?

Question 9: Who warned the Jewish council not to proceed with such an action?

Question 10: What was his relationship to Saul?

Question 11: He warned that in persecuting the apostles they might even be found _____.

Question 12: Acts 6:7. "Obedient to the faith" means believing the gospel, accepting Jesus as Savior, and following him. Who were obedient to the faith?

The conversion of so many religious leaders may have affected Saul deeply, even if it did move him to fight the Christian doctrine at the time.

Question 13: Acts 6:8. What factors could have influenced Saul's serious consideration of the gospel that Stephen preached?

Question 14: Acts 6:11-15. How did Stephen impress Saul and all the members of the council at his trial?

Question 15: Acts 7:51-54. How do you suppose Stephen's sermon affected Saul? The Bible says the listeners were enraged. The climax made him furious. Why?

- a) Saul was convicted, but became angry with the preacher instead of confessing his guilt.
- b) Stephen's sermon was an articulate presentation of the evidence.
- c) Saul acknowledged Stephen's educational background.
- d) Saul became zealous when he noticed Stephen's deep knowledge in the Bible.

“They ground their teeth at him.” Instead of repenting they stoned Stephen to death.

Question 16: Acts 7:55-56. What did Stephen see?



At the right hand of God was a position of honor and authority. Perhaps Saul could not forget Stephen's vision. If Jesus really were in heaven at God's right hand, this meant that he was the Messiah; his claims and teachings were true. If so, Saul was opposing God, just as Gamaliel had said.

Question 17: Matthew 5:44. We want to notice one more influence that helped lead Saul to Christ. What did Jesus tell his followers to do for those who persecuted them?

When Saul became the chief persecutor of the church he also became the target of the prayers of the Christians. God answers prayer!

2. Conversion

Please read now the record in Acts 9:1-19.

Question 18: What finally changed Saul, completely losing his theological debate or a personal revelation of Christ?

C. Apostle of Christ

Objective 4: Demonstrate an understanding of Paul's character, ministry, and writings.

Question 19: Acts 9:15. To whom Jesus going to send Saul as a witness for him?

Question 20: How soon after his conversion did Paul begin to preach the gospel? Acts. 9:20

STUDY PROJECT 1

1. Discuss the influences that led to Saul's conversion and the importance of such influences to win people to Christ today.
2. Dramatize the conversion of Paul based on Acts 9, 22 and 26.

Lesson 2

Preparation of the Defense

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. Defense of the Faith Needed in Galatia
 - 1. The Galatians
 - 2. The Crisis in Galatia
 - 3. Paul's Responsibility
- B. Defense of the Faith Needed in Early Church
 - 1. Transitional Issues in Christianity
 - a. Step 1
 - b. Step 2
 - c. Step 3
 - d. Step 4
 - 2. Conflict with the Judaizers
- C. Defense of the Faith Needed in Today
 - 1. Dealing with Legalism Today
 - 2. Development of the Defense

LESSON OBJECTIVES

- 1. Show the importance of Paul's letter to the Galatians in meeting the crisis of legalism.
- 2. Use a map to explain who the Galatians were.
- 3. Use a chronology chart to explain when this epistle was written.
- 4. Explain who the Judaizers were and the crisis they produced in the churches of Galatia.
- 5. Appreciate more deeply the responsibility of Christian ministers to teach the pure gospel of Jesus Christ and defend the church against error.
- 6. Describe the period of transition in the early church.

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7. Appreciate the firm stand the early church leaders took for Christian liberty.
8. Compare the crisis in Galatia with similar crises that some churches face today.
9. Use an outline of the epistle to the Galatians and give its five main divisions from memory.

WORD STUDY

- *Chronology* – table or list that gives the dates of events in the order in which they happened. This order is called chronological sequence. The chronology you will study in this lesson list Paul's missionary journeys and the dates when he wrote his epistles. However, no one knows for sure the dates of these events.
- *Crisis* – a crucial point in progress of an affair or of a series events. We speak of the crisis of a disease as the turning point toward life or death. The conflict between the gospel of faith that Paul preached and the teachings of the Judaizers had produced crisis in the Galatian churches.
- *Judaize* – to conform to Jewish rule, customs, and ideas, or to get others to conform to them. The Judaizers that we study about in Galatians were the law Jewish Christians who tried to get all the Gentile Christians to become Jews and follow all the religious regulations of Judaism (that is, of the Jews).
- *Justification* – being freed from the guilt of sin and its punishment and receiving the righteousness of God. We will have a fuller definition later. Paul wrote this letter to the Galatians to let them know that justification is by faith in Jesus Christ alone. The Judaizers were teaching that justification was by faith in Christ plus keeping the Jewish law.
- *Proselyte* – a convert from one religion to another. The Jews in New Testament times had won many Gentiles from their worship of idols to the worship of the one true God. These proselytes became Jews.
- *Heresy* – a belief or opinion contrary to the established doctrines of a church or a religious system.
- *The law* – the code of laws that God gave Moses, also called the Mosaic Law. This term is also used for the whole system of Jewish

religious requirements. We are spelling it with a capital L in this course to distinguish it from governmental law in general.

- *Legalism* – insistence on keeping certain rules (or the law) in order to be saved or to maintain a right standing with God.

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

A. Defense of the Faith Needed in Galatia

Objective 1: Show the importance of Paul's letter to the Galatians in meeting the crisis of legalism.

When we mention the crisis in Galatia, three questions come to our minds: 1) Who were the Galatians? 2) What was the crisis? 3) What was Paul's responsibility? Answering these questions will help you to see more easily the purpose and structure of the book of Galatians.

1. The Galatians

Objective 2: Use a map to explain who the Galatians were.

Question 1: Read Galatians 1:1-2. To whom does Paul address this letter?

Question 2: Read these passages in Acts and name the cities where the people received the message gladly but later turned against Paul.

a) 13:14

b) 14:1-5

c) 14:6, 13, 19

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Question 3: Look at the map of Paul's Missionary Journeys (pp. vii-viii). Find Antioch (in Galatia), Lystra, Iconium, and Derbe.

Question 4: On which missionary journeys did Paul visit Antioch, Lystra, Iconium, and Derbe?

Paul founded several churches in the southern part of the Roman administrative province of Galatia. Sometimes the province was called Lycaonia. We believe that he wrote this epistle to the churches in this area.

Objective 3: Use a chronology chart to explain when this epistle was written.

Question 5: Match the events of Paul's life to the dates.

Paul's travel to Jerusalem for the Council • • 49 AD

Paul's execution in Rome • • 45-49 AD

Paul's first missionary journey • • 49 or 50 AD

The writing of Paul's letter to Galatians • • 68 AD

The southern area was already evangelized at the close of the first missionary journey. It seems that Paul wrote this letter shortly after his first missionary journey and just before his journey to the Jerusalem Council in A.D. 49. We know that the subjects Paul wrote about in Galatians were dealt with in the Jerusalem Council (Acts 15). If this had taken place already, Paul would surely have mentioned the decisions of the council in Galatians. The council definitely decided that Gentile Christians would not have to be circumcised or keep the Jewish laws. Since Paul does not mention this ruling, we may suppose that Galatians was written before the Jerusalem Council.

2. The Crisis in Galatia

Objective 4: Explain who the Judaizers were and the crisis they produced in the churches of Galatia.

The Galatian churches were made up of both Jews and Gentiles. Some Jewish Christians had always thought that any Gentile who wanted to be saved had to become a Jew and keep the Mosaic Law. But Paul had taught them that Jesus had died for their sins and faith in him brought salvation to Jew and Gentile alike.

Now some questions had arisen that were of vital importance to the Galatians and to Christianity: Is the gospel the Jewish religion plus faith in Jesus Christ? Is Christianity a sect within Judaism, an extension of the Mosaic Law? Does a person need to become a Jew and conform to Jewish culture in order to be a Christian? Is Christianity a legal system? Is it faith in Jesus Christ plus the law?

WHAT IS THE GOSPEL?

Religion + Faith in Christ = Gospel?

Jewish Culture + Faith = Gospel?

Law + Faith = Gospel?

Faith in Christ alone = Gospel?

Question 6: Who were the Judaizers?

- a) Reformers in the Jewish religion.
- b) Liberals in the Christian churches.
- c) Legalists insisting on Jewish laws.
- d) Converts to Christianity from Judaism.

Question 7: What was the Judaizers' doctrine of salvation?

Question 8: What was Paul's doctrine of salvation?

Question 9: What was the Judaizers' basic error?

- a) They didn't believe in Christ.
- b) They added something to the work of Christ as the basis for salvation.
- c) They substituted the Mosaic Law for Christ

The basic error of the Judaizers was not that they substituted something for Christ's work, but rather that they tried to add something to it. Have you ever seen anything like that happen? They were distorting the gospel message that Paul had originally given the churches. They insisted that in order to become a good Christian, a person first had to become a good Jew. They insisted that the Gentile Christians had to be circumcised and keep certain parts of the Jewish law in order to be saved. They taught that salvation is by faith in Christ and by keeping the law.

Question 10: Do you think that Judaizers were saved? Why or why not?

Question 11: Describe briefly the crisis of the Gentile Christians in Galatia.

3. Paul's Responsibility

Objective 5: Appreciate more deeply the responsibility of Christian ministers to teach the pure gospel of Jesus Christ and defend the church against error.

Question 12: What does Paul call the Galatians in 4:19?

You may have noticed when reading Galatians that Paul feels a deep sense of responsibility for these churches. This is because he founded the churches. He won these people to the Lord and loved them like his own children. They were about to turn away from their faith in Christ. Paul—their spiritual father—loved them so much that he wanted to protect them against this danger and strengthen their faith in Christ.

Question 13: Are you concerned for the spiritual danger that threatens some person or congregation because of false doctrine? What can you do about it? State the problem as a prayer reminder for yourself and pray about it now.

B. Defense of the Faith Needed in Early Church

To appreciate the importance of the epistle to the Galatians, we must realize that all Christianity faced the same crisis. It was a time of transition. We need to trace briefly some of the events that led to this crisis.

As you move through this second section of Lesson 2 you will look for answers to the following key questions:

1. What transitional issues arose during the establishment of the early church?
2. What stand did early church leaders take with regard to Christian liberty?

1. Transitional Issues in Christianity

Objective 6: Describe the period of transition in the early church.

Question 14: In the very beginning Christianity was

- a) recognized as a new religion.
- b) regarded as a branch of Judaism.
- c) regarded as a Gentile religion.
- d) viewed as a religion for Jews and Gentiles.

At the time of Paul's conversion, the church was made up almost entirely of Jews who had accepted Jesus as their Messiah. There were few Gentile converts. After the mission of Barnabas and Paul, the church began to grow rapidly among the Gentiles. This brought up an important question: How were these Gentiles to be received into the church? The Judaizers answered, "They must be circumcised and become good Jews as well as have faith in Jesus." They interpreted Christianity as the Jewish religion plus faith in Jesus Christ. To them, the gospel was an extension of the law of Moses.

The transition from Judaism to Christianity was slow in the early church. You can find the important events from the book of Acts.

a. Step 1

Question 15: What event first led the transition from Judaism to Christianity? Acts 8.

Question 16: Who were the Samaritans?

Question 17: Why was this event a significant step in the transition of the church from Judaism to its international nature?

b. Step 2

Question 18: What was the second event and what was its significance in this transition? Acts 9.



c. Step 3

Question 19: Which event from Acts 10 contributed to this transition?

Question 20: Who was Cornelius and why was Peter's ministry to his household an important step?

d. Step 4

Question 21: What was the final event? Acts 11:19-24.

Question 22: Name the church which was the center of world evangelism that sent Barnabas and Paul out to evangelize the Gentiles?

- a) The main church in Jerusalem.
- b) The church in Caesarea.
- c) The new church in Antioch of Syria.
- d) The church in Antioch of Pisidia.

Question 23: Who had taken the gospel to Antioch of Syria? Acts 11:19.

2. Conflict with the Judaizers

Objective 7: Appreciate the firm stand the early church leaders took for Christian liberty.

Question 24: According to Acts 15:1, who were the men who taught the Christians?

Question 25: What did these men teach the Christians there?

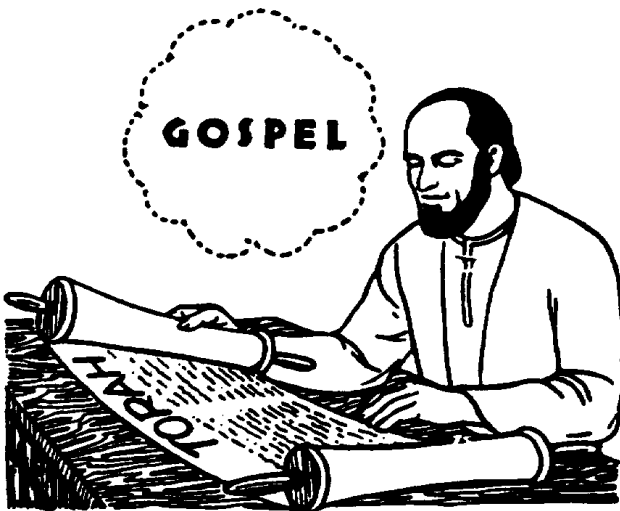
Question 26: Where did the teaching take place?

The period of transition was a period of crisis both for the individual churches (such as in Antioch and Galatia) and also for Christianity as a whole. Wherever Paul preached the gospel of salvation through faith in Jesus Christ, the Judaizers followed him and tried to get the Gentile converts to be circumcised and become Jews.

Question 27: What two things does Acts 15:5 tell you about the Judaizers?

Question 28: What did they decide at Antioch? Acts 15:2

Question 29: In Acts 15:7-11 what is Peter's advice about receiving Gentiles into the church and belief as to how they were to be saved?



Question 30: Does James speak in favor of the Judaizers or against them?
Acts 15:19-21

Question 31: Did the teaching of the Judaizers originate with the apostles in Jerusalem? Acts 15:24

The decision of the council was clearly against the Judaizers. Peter and James, the half brother of Jesus, supported Paul and Barnabas in favor of freeing the Gentile Christians from the bondage of Mosaic Law. Christianity was clearly seen to be a matter of faith in Jesus Christ (15:11). Gentiles would enter the church on the basis of faith in Jesus Christ alone.

C. Defense of the Faith Needed in Today

1. Dealing with Legalism Today

<i>Objective 8: Compare the crisis in Galatia with similar crises that some churches face today.</i>
--

Through the ages, Christianity has been threatened and shaken by false doctrine that has crept into the church. Sometimes it has been a legalistic attitude rather than a return to the Torah or law of Moses. Different churches have had their own set of regulations that were considered essential for people to keep if they wanted to go to heaven. Many people still are trusting in their own efforts to lead a Christian life as a way to salvation. Some feel that the social gospel—helping those who are in need—is the path to salvation. Others think that belonging to a Christian church will save them. For all of these Galatians brings God's message for their own spiritual crisis—"The righteous shall live by faith!"

DOCTRINES OF SALVATION	
Judaism	By keeping God's laws
Judaizers	By faith in Christ and keeping the law
Paul	By faith in Christ (and not by works)
Galatians	Faith in Christ? Or Faith + Works?
Christians today	What will you teach them?

Question 32: Is there legalism in your church that might be eliminated by the teaching of Paul's doctrine of salvation?

2. Development of the Defense

Objective 9: Use an outline of the epistle to the Galatians and give its five main divisions from memory.

The outline of Galatians below is the one that you will be using in your study of this epistle:

Outline of Galatians		
<i>Theme: The righteous shall live by faith.</i>		
Historical Argument Galatians 1-2	Theological Argument Galatians 3-4	Practical Argument Galatians 5-6
<i>Paul is defending the gospel using his personal testimony.</i>	<i>Paul is defending the gospel using the Scriptures.</i>	<i>Paul is defending the gospel showing that the gospel brings a victorious life to believers.</i>
God Gave Paul His Gospel (Gal. 1) - Paul's Apostleship and Gospel (1:1-12) - Paul's Conversion and Commission (1:13-24) Apostles Recognize Paul's Gospel (Gal. 2) - Consultation with Church Leaders (2:1-5) - Official Recognition Given (2:6-10) - Peter Corrected by Paul's Gospel (2:11-21)	Scripture Teaches the Gospel of Faith (Gal. 3) - Gospel of Faith Received by Galatians (3:1-5) - Gospel of Faith Given to Abraham (3:6-9) - Relationship of Gospel to Law (3:10-25) - Children of God by Faith (3:26-29) Gospel Produces Sons—Not Slaves (Gal. 4) - From Bondage to Sonship (4:1-5) - Ceremonial Religion and Spiritual Experience (4:6-11) - Tragedy of Return to Bondage (4:12-20) - Bondage or Freedom—Not Both (4:21-31)	Gospel Stands the Test of Life (Gal. 5-6) - Results of Works and Faith (5:1-26) - Gospel Applied to Daily Life (6:1-18)

Question 33: Learn from memory its five main divisions and write them below beside the chapter references.

Galatians 1 _____

Galatians 2 _____

Galatians 3 _____

Galatians 4 _____

Galatians 5-6 _____

STUDY PROJECT 2

1. Compare the crisis in Galatia with similar crises that some churches face today. How can we solve these crises?
2. Dramatize the Jerusalem council based on Acts 15.

Unit II

Paul Defends His Gospel

- 3. God Gave Paul His Gospel**
- 4. Apostles Recognize Paul's Gospel**
- 5. Scripture Teaches the Gospel of Faith**
- 6. Gospel Produces Sons—Not Slaves**
- 7. Gospel Stands the Test of Life**

Lesson 3

God Gave Paul His Gospel

(Galatians 1)

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. Paul's Apostleship and Gospel (1:1-12)
 - 1. Apostolic Greeting (1:1-5)
 - 2. Only One True Gospel (1:6-9)
 - a. Finality of the Gospel
 - b. Relationship of Messenger to Message
 - 3. The Gospel from God—Not Man (1:10-12)
- B. Paul's Conversion and Commission (1:13-24)
 - 1. His Opposition to the Gospel (1:13-14)
 - 2. Revelation and Direction from God (1:15-24)
 - a. Chosen by God for Service
 - b. Directed for Service

LESSON OBJECTIVES

- 1. Define apostle and compare the source of Paul's apostleship in Christianity with that of his apostleship in Judaism.
- 2. Define sovereignty of God, Lord and church, and apply the truths they express to your own life.
- 3. Give the basic principle by which all messages or revelations must be measured before we accept them as from God.
- 4. Discuss and apply to your own ministry Paul's words about the source of his call and of his message.
- 5. Describe why Paul emphasizes his former devotion to Judaism in the letter to Galatians.
- 6. Point out the sovereignty of God in Paul's call and apply it to your calling.

7. Point out the proofs that Paul gives of his apostleship in Galatians 1 and recognize their importance to the rest of the epistle and its acceptance.

WORD STUDY

- *Lord* (1:3) – a title of Christ that recognizes his right to rule over us. When the early Christians said, “Jesus is Lord,” they meant he was God and had the right to rule their lives.
- *Gospel* (1:6) – good news; the good news of salvation.
- *Predestination* – an action of God in deciding beforehand what is to happen. Paul speaks of the plan God had for him before he was born (separated from his mother's womb).
- *Sovereign* – supreme ruler. When we speak of the sovereignty of God, we mean he is above all other power or authority in the universe. As creator of all things, he owns all things. He has the absolute right to rule over all. When Paul was converted, he called Jesus Lord, recognizing his sovereignty and asking, “What do you want me to do?”

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

A. Paul's Apostleship and Gospel (1:1-12)

From this point on, most of your study will be an analysis (careful examination of each part) of Scripture passages. So, each time you come to a new section in your study guide, read the Bible passage reference in the heading of the section, then go ahead with the comments and study questions for that section.

1. Apostolic Greeting (1:1-5)

Objective 1: Define apostle and compare the source of Paul's apostleship in Christianity with that of his apostleship in Judaism.

Objective 2: Define sovereignty of God, Lord and church, and apply the truths they express to your own life.

Question 1: Look again now at Galatians 1:1. On the basis of what you learned in Lesson 2 about the problem in the Galatian churches, why does Paul speak so strongly about being an apostle? Do not they know this already? Explain.

Question 2: What three basic statements does Paul make in verse 1 about the source of his apostleship? Two are negative and one is positive.

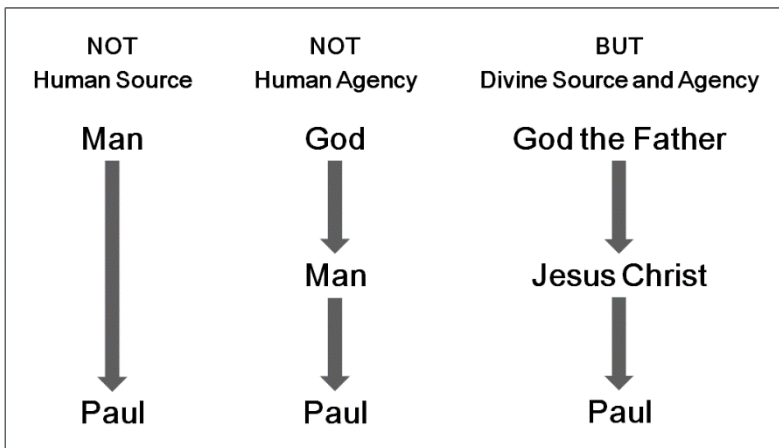
a)

b)

c)

The following sketch illustrates what Paul says about his calling to ministry:

Paul's Call and Apostleship



Paul's missionary call came from God, not from people. God had chosen him for his work. God appointed him to preach the gospel to the Gentiles. Paul was sent out by God, not by people. Later we will see that the church recognized the call.

Paul had once been an apostle of Judaism sent by the high priest and the Jewish elders to arrest the Christians in Damascus. But on the way he met and surrendered to a higher Authority. And from that day he had been an apostle of Jesus Christ. His apostleship was from (of) God, and he was carrying out his mission by the power and authority of God.

Question 3: Now let's look at verse 2 in Paul's apostolic greeting. Who joins Paul in sending greetings to the churches of Galatia? Answer in Paul's words.

Question 4: What does church mean in the New Testament?

- a) Cathedral
- b) Called out assembly
- c) Sent ones
- d) Temple of God

The word which is often translated “church” is *ekklesia* in Greek. Its basic meaning is that of being called out. It was used by the New Testament writers as an appropriate word for God's people who had been called out of the world and who assembled to worship and serve him.

Question 5: In verse 3, what two things does Paul ask God to give the Galatian churches?

- a)
- b)

Question 6: Who is the source of these two blessings?

Question 7: Why does this prayer seem especially important in view of the Galatians' problem?

- a) They were challenging Paul's apostolic authority.
- b) They were about to keep the law as a condition for salvation in confusion.
- c) They had seen Peter's hypocrisy.
- d) They were losing their faith in Christ.

Now let's direct our attention to the Lord Jesus Christ. He is the center of Paul's gospel. In fact, Paul says: "We preach Christ." For him, Christianity is "Christ in us, the hope of glory." Salvation through faith in Christ (not through keeping rules and regulations) is the gospel that he is defending. So even in his apostolic greeting he makes some important statements about Christ.

Question 8: What does Paul say about Christ in each of these verses of Galatians?

- a) 1:1
- b) 1:3
- c) 1:4

Paul presents him as our Lord Jesus Christ:

1. Lord means he is God, our sovereign Ruler.
2. Jesus means he is our Savior.
3. Christ means he is our anointed Messiah, the Deliverer sent by God.

Question 9: What does the word Lord mean as applied to Jesus Christ?

- a) Divine Sovereign
- b) Respected Sir
- c) Divine Teacher
- d) Great Ruler

Question 10: Is your life surrendered to the Lord Jesus Christ? Are you seeking to know and do the will of God?

2. Only One True Gospel (1:6-9)

Objective 3: Give the basic principle by which all messages or revelations must be measured before we accept them as from God.

At this point Paul takes up the challenge of the Judaizers and plunges right into the defense of his gospel.

Question 11: In what had the Galatians been called? 1:6

Question 12: Let's remember what the teaching that Paul calls another gospel was. The Judaizers in the churches taught that to be saved a person had to:

Question 13: What does gospel mean?

Now notice how many times Paul uses the word gospel in these four verses. It is the Greek word *euaggelion* which means good message or good news.

Question 14: What does Paul say that the Judaizers are doing to the gospel of Christ? 1:7

Question 15: In verse 7 Paul says that in reality this other gospel is not a gospel at all. It cannot be. Why?

Question 16: What was the result of this distorted gospel on the Galatians? 1:7

Question 17: What is the standard by which we must measure all religious teachings, revelations, visions, or angelic messages? 1:8-9

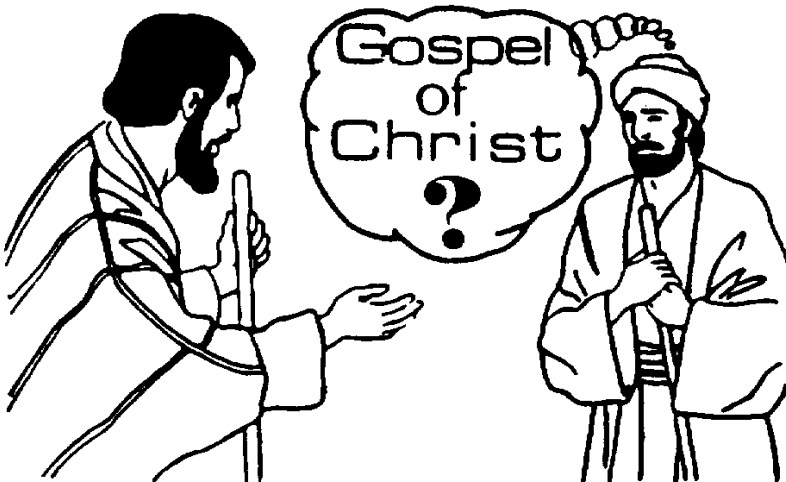
The principle in verses 8-9 deals with two truths: 1) The finality of the gospel, 2) The relationship of the messenger to his message.

a. Finality of the Gospel

First, the gospel is a final revelation. There will be no more revelations that will add to the message of God's redeeming work. It is not to be changed or replaced by any newer revelation. The gospel of the grace of Christ that God sent Paul out to preach—the good news of salvation by faith in Christ—is the true and everlasting gospel. There can be no true revelation of a new way to get right with God, because faith in Christ is the only way.

b. Relationship of Messenger to Message

Second, the gospel becomes the basis for evaluating not only the message but also the messenger. No matter what credentials the messenger may have, these do not commend the message, but rather the message commends the messenger.



Question 18: How can we apply this principle? What should we do if someone gives a message in our church that is supposed to be a prophecy from the Holy Spirit, or someone tells a dream or revelation that he says is from God?

- a) Accept all prophecies and revelations as from the Spirit of God.
- b) Accept anything as from the Holy Spirit if a member in good standing in the church or a minister in good standing gives it as a prophecy, interpretation, or revelation.
- c) Judge the source of the message by the kind of life that the messenger lives.
- d) Ask ourselves: "Does the message or revelation agree with the gospel of Christ?"

3. The Gospel from God—Not Man (1:10-12)

Objective 4: Discuss and apply to your own ministry Paul's words about the source of his call and of his message.

Question 19: What four statements does Paul make about the source of his gospel in 1:11-12? Three are about where it did not come from. The fourth is about where it did come from.



These verses can have a practical application for each of us, too. Although we cannot expect to have exactly the same experience as Paul, we should all know Christ personally. No one can possibly serve Christ effectively who has not had a personal encounter with him. Paul's words can be applied to every minister's message, too. Like Paul, we too should receive our message from God.

B. Paul's Conversion and Commission (1:13-24)

1. His Opposition to the Gospel (1:13-14)

Objective 5: Describe why Paul emphasizes his former devotion to Judaism in the letter to Galatians.

Question 20: What relationship does Paul see between Judaism and Christianity?

- a) One is just as acceptable as the other.
- b) Judaism is superior to Christianity in some respects.
- c) Judaism and Christianity are really the same religion.
- d) Judaism and Christianity are different religions.

Question 21: In the light of these verses how would you answer a person who says: "It does not make any difference what you believe, just so you are sincere"?

Question 22: Why did Paul emphasize his former complete devotion to Judaism in this letter to the Galatians?

2. Revelation and Direction from God (1:15-24)

In these verses Paul continues to develop what he stated in verses 11-12. Here he shows that his gospel and ministry are from God and not from the other apostles. He was chosen by God for the ministry, called and converted by his grace, and directed by God in his ministry.

a. Chosen by God for Service

Objective 6: Point out the sovereignty of God in Paul's call and apply it to your calling.

Question 23: Compare Jeremiah 1:4-5 with Galatians 1:15-16. What is similar between Jeremiah's experience and Paul's?

Let's look at verses 15 and 16 again. They show us two main acts of God, followed by the immediate purpose and then by the ultimate purpose of these acts. Let's illustrate it like this:

God had set me apart before I was born ⇒ First Main Act

Called me by his grace ⇒ Second Main Act

To reveal his Son to me ⇒ Immediate Purpose

**In order that I might preach him among the
Gentiles ⇒ Ultimate Purpose**

Question 24: Do you believe that God has a plan for your life where he has called you to serve him in a certain way? If so, how does this affect your attitude toward his work for you?

Question 25: Read verses 15 and 16 with your name in them in the place of "me" and "I."

b. Directed for Service

Objective 7: Point out the proofs that Paul gives of his apostleship in Galatians 1 and recognize their importance to the rest of the epistle and its acceptance.

Question 26: Why does Paul tell all about what he did immediately after his conversion?

- a) Paul lets the Galatians know that he didn't go to the apostles or church leaders in Jerusalem to find out what message he should preach or where he should go to preach.
- b) Paul lets the Galatians know that God appointed him as an apostle for the Gentiles.
- c) Paul lets the Galatians know that he wanted to glorify God through his ministry.
- d) Paul lets the Galatians know how he preached the gospel regardless of difficulties and persecution.

Question 27: Who were the two main leaders of the church that Paul met with in Jerusalem? 1:18-19

- a) James and John
- b) Simon and Andrew
- c) Barnabas and Thomas
- d) Peter and James

If Paul had been preaching a false gospel, Peter and James would surely have corrected him but we have no report of such a problem. On the contrary, a wonderful report about Paul went out to all the churches in Judea.

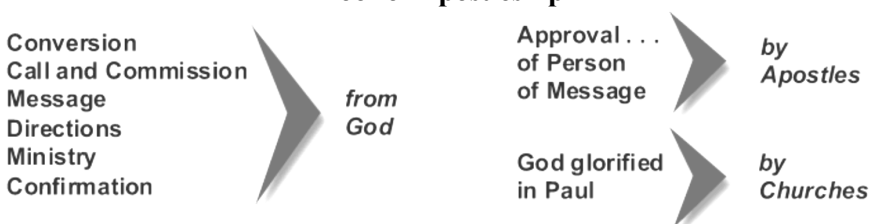
Question 28: What report about Paul's preaching did the churches hear? 1:22-23

Question 29: What is the final proof of apostleship given in Galatians 1:24?

Question 30: Beside each point of Paul's defense in the first chapter of Galatians write the reference where it is found. Place an x beside those that you feel can be applied in some way to Christian workers today. Think of them with respect to your own call and message. Add any comment or explanation you wish.

- a) ☐ He presents himself as an apostle of Jesus Christ.
- b) ☐ He shows that he received his gospel and call as a direct revelation from God, not from other people.
- c) ☐ He presents his gospel as the one true gospel by which all other messengers and messages are to be judged.
- d) ☐ God continued to direct his ministry by revelation, reaffirmed his call to the Gentiles, and sent him to the Gentiles (including the Galatians).
- e) ☐ He shows he was in fellowship with church leaders in Jerusalem. They did not question his message or ministry.
- f) ☐ The churches of Judea reported that he was preaching the same faith (gospel) that he once fought.
- g) ☐ His ministry caused the Christians to praise God.

Proof of Apostleship



In closing, let's think once more about verse 24 and its importance for us. A leader of the church may be the occasion for people either to praise God, as in this verse, or to blaspheme him, as in Romans 2:24. May we be able to say with Paul, "And they glorified God because of me."

STUDY PROJECT 3

1. Discuss the ways in which God calls people to certain ministries today. Write down your own testimony of calling to the ministry you are involved now. If you are not involved in a ministry, write about the ministry you would like to be involved and state your reasons for your interest.

2. What is your former religion? How can you use your past religious experience to your current ministry?

Unit Exam 1

Part 1 – If the statement is true, circle T, if false, circle F.

1. T/F Paul started his ministry after meeting Peter and James at Jerusalem.
2. T/F Galatian churches were founded during Paul's first missionary journey.
3. T/F Paul's issue of practical argument is that a believer's life should be better than that of a law-keeper because of the power of the Holy Spirit.
4. T/F The church at Antioch of Syria was founded by Paul.
5. T/F Because we were saved by Jesus Christ, we should not use our experiences in our former religion in our ministry.
6. T/F Even though Judaizers kept the law as the basis for salvation they would be saved because at least they believed in Jesus Christ as their personal Savior.
7. T/F Legalism helps the church to grow spiritually.
8. T/F According to Acts 15, Jerusalem Council decided to have the Gentile Christians to keep some part of the law as the basis for salvation.
9. T/F As long as somebody believes Jesus as the Savior, we should accept the person as our spiritual brother or sister.

Part 2 – Short answer.

10. In what city and province was the apostle Paul born?
11. What was Paul's Jewish name?
12. What is Paul's teacher's name?

13. Before Paul's conversion, to what Jewish sect did he belong?
14. Before Paul's conversion what did he think a person had to do in order to have eternal life?
15. What was Paul's attitude toward the Christians before his conversion? Why?
16. What was Paul's attitude toward the law before his conversion?
17. What is the meaning of “gospel”?

Part 3 – Mark ONE correct answer.

18. When did Paul write to the Galatians?
 - a) During his first missionary journey.
 - b) Just after his first missionary journey.
 - c) Just after the apostolic council at Jerusalem.
 - d) During his third missionary journey.
19. What is the theme of the Galatian epistle?
 - a) The just shall live by faith.
 - b) Paul - the defender of the faith.
 - c) Justification by works.
 - d) Practical advice for the Christian.
20. What is the date of the letter to the Galatians according to your chronology chart?
 - a) A.D. 33
 - b) A.D. 49
 - c) A.D. 57
 - d) A.D. 68
21. Paul uses three arguments. To which argument does Abraham's story belong?
 - a) Historical argument.
 - b) Theological argument.
 - c) Practical argument.

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22. The main meaning of "justified" as used in Galatians is
 - a) acquitted and given a right standing before God.
 - b) acquitted and brought into the right relationship with the church.
 - c) cleansed from moral guilt and given a new nature.
 - d) freed from the guilt and power of sin.
23. Who were the Judaizers?
 - a) Reformers in the Jewish religion.
 - b) Liberals in the Christian churches.
 - c) Legalists insisting on Jewish laws.
 - d) Converts to Christianity from Judaism.
24. What was the Judaizers' basic error?
 - a) They didn't believe in Christ.
 - b) They added something to the work of Christ as the basis for salvation.
 - c) They substituted the Mosaic Law for Christ.
25. In the very beginning Christianity was
 - a) recognized as a new religion.
 - b) regarded as a branch of Judaism.
 - c) regarded as a Gentile religion.
 - d) viewed as a religion for Jews and Gentiles.
26. The account of the transition of the early church is found
 - a) in the Gospel of John.
 - b) in the Book of Acts.
 - c) in the Epistle to the Galatians.
 - d) only in the writings of the early church fathers.
27. Which church sent out Barnabas and Paul to evangelize the Gentiles?
 - a) The main church in Jerusalem.
 - b) The church in Caesarea.
 - c) The new church in Antioch of Syria.
 - d) The church in Antioch of Pisidia.

28. What does church mean in the New Testament?
- a) Cathedral.
 - b) Called out assembly.
 - c) Sent ones.
 - d) Temple of God.
29. What does the word Lord mean as applied to Jesus Christ?
- a) Divine Sovereign.
 - b) Respected Sir.
 - c) Divine Teacher.
 - d) Great Ruler.
30. Someone tells you a dream or a message that is supposed to be a prophecy of the Holy Spirit. What should you do?
- a) Accept all prophecies and revelations as from the Spirit of God.
 - b) Accept anything as from the Holy Spirit if a member in good standing in the church or a minister in good standing gives it as prophecy, interpretation, or revelation.
 - c) Judge the source of the message by the kind of life that the messenger lives.
 - d) Ask yourself: "Does the message or revelation agree with the gospel of Christ?"
31. What relationship does Paul see between Judaism and Christianity?
- a) One is just as acceptable as the other.
 - b) Judaism is superior to Christianity in some respects.
 - c) Judaism and Christianity are really the same religion.
 - d) Judaism and Christianity are different religions.

Part 4 – Answer the following questions according to the instruction.

32-36. Match the chapters of Galatians to the main topics.

- | | | | |
|-------------|---|---|---------------------------------------|
| Chapter 1 | • | • | Scripture Teaches the Gospel of Faith |
| Chapter 2 | • | • | Gospel Stands the Test of Life |
| Chapter 3 | • | • | Apostles Recognize Paul's Gospel |
| Chapter 4 | • | • | God Gave Paul His Gospel |
| Chapter 5-6 | • | • | Gospel Produces Sons—Not Slaves |

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37. List four influences (found in the workbook) that led to Paul's conversion.

-
-
-
-

38. Name four steps in the transition of the early church from Judaism to Christianity.

Step 1:

Step 2:

Step 3:

Step 4:

39. Describe the doctrinal crisis in Galatia by explaining the thinking of the following persons:

The apostle Paul	•	• Faith alone
Judaizers	•	• Confusion
Gentile Christians	•	• Faith + work

40. Write down three ways how a person can be sure of his calling for the ministry.

-
-
-

Lesson 4

Apostles Recognize Paul's Gospel (Galatians 2)

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. Consultation with Church Leaders (2:1-5)
 - 1. Visit to Jerusalem (2:1-2)
 - a. Time and Purpose
 - b. Divine Guidance
 - 2. Test Case for Gentile Christians (2:3-5)
- B. Official Recognition Given (2:6-10)
 - 1. Recognition of Paul's Gospel (2:6-8)
 - 2. Recognition of Paul as an Apostle (2:8-10)
- C. Peter Corrected by Paul's Gospel (2:11-21)
 - 1. Peter's Mistake and Paul's Rebuke (2:11-14)
 - 2. Justification by Faith without Law (2:15-18)
 - 3. Dead to the Law—Alive in Christ (2:19-21)

MEMORY VERSE

Galatians 2:16
Galatians 2:20

LESSON OBJECTIVES

- 1. Explain the purpose and importance of the visit described in Galatians 2:1-10 and give Paul's reason for telling the Galatians about it.
- 2. State three ways in which the Holy Spirit guides Christians.
- 3. Explain the principle Paul followed in having Timothy circumcised and refusing to have Titus circumcised.
- 4. State the validity of the church's recognition of a person's call and ministry.
- 5. Describe Paul's validity as an apostle.
- 6. Apply in your life and ministry the principles given in this chapter for dealing with hypocrisy and other problems.
- 7. Compare the problem of Jewish-Christian relations in the early church to similar problems today.

8. Quote Galatians 2:16, 20 from memory and use these key verses in your life and ministry.

WORD STUDY

- *Circumcise* (2:3) – cut off the foreskin as a sign of separation for God and acceptance of the covenant God made with Abraham. Jewish male infants were circumcised when they were eight days old. Gentile converts to Judaism were circumcised. Circumcision was to them what baptism is to Christians. Paul refers to the Jews as the circumcision, and to the Gentiles as the uncircumcision.
- *Compromise* – to give up something in order to gain something. Peter compromised his convictions (acted against something he believed in) when he stopped eating with the Gentiles in order to avoid criticism.
- *Hypocrite* – a person who pretends to be something that he is not. The word originally meant an actor in a play.
- *Righteousness* – rightness, right living, right standing with God, goodness.
- *Transgressor* (2:18) – lawbreaker, sinner

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

A. Consultation with Church Leaders (2:1-5)

1. Visit to Jerusalem (2:1-2)

a. Time and Purpose

Objective 1: Explain the purpose and importance of the visit described in Galatians 2:1-10 and give Paul's reason for telling the Galatians about it.

Question 1: According to verse 2, how did Paul set his gospel on this occasion?

- a) Publicly to the whole church.
- b) Privately to the whole church board.
- c) Privately to the principal leaders.

- Question 2:** What was Paul's purpose in setting his gospel before the leaders of the Jerusalem church?
- to find out if his message was all right.
 - to have their approval and backing in his missionary work.
 - to please the Judaizers.
 - to prevent misunderstandings between Jewish Church in Jerusalem and Gentile Church.

b. Divine Guidance

<i>Objective 2: State three ways in which the Holy Spirit guides Christians.</i>
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- Question 3:** In Galatians 2:2 Paul says he went up because of a _____.

What do you think he meant by this? The Lord led him to go but he doesn't tell us how the revelation came. Here are three possibilities:

1. He could have had a direct revelation from God in a vision, dream or inner voice.
2. He could have had group guidance as God revealed his will to an entire group.
3. He could have been guided by a prophecy given through the prophet Agabus about a famine that would come to Judea.

- Question 4:** We have mentioned three types of revelation. Check the ones that God still uses to lead his people today.
- Direct revelation in vision, dream, or inner voice.
 - Group guidance through consultation in the church or direction given to the church.
 - Prophecy or other manifestations of the gifts of the Holy Spirit.
 - All of the above.

- Question 5:** What are other ways that God might use to guide his people?

Question 6: Do you think that the more direct ways that God leads are more spiritual than the indirect ways? For example, is it more spiritual to be led by a vision than by circumstances that indicate what you should do? Why?

The Bible never says that direct guidance is more spiritual than indirect. Any way that God uses to lead us is divine guidance and spiritual!

Question 7: How did the church receive God's guidance in a problem about Gentile Christians? Acts 15

- a) In a vision.
- b) By a prophecy.
- c) In group consultation.

Question 8: Which kind of guidance is more spiritual?

- a) A vision.
- b) Group consultation.
- c) Neither.

Question 9: Which method of guidance does God use most often with his children?

- a) Visions
- b) Prophecies
- c) Dreams
- d) Group consultation
- e) The Bible

2. Test Case for Gentile Christians (2:3-5)

Objective 3: Explain the principle Paul followed in having Timothy circumcised and refusing to have Titus circumcised.

Question 10: In verse 3, Paul said that Titus was not forced to be circumcised. Who demanded Titus to be circumcised? 2:4

Question 11: What about their tactics? Were they sincere and open in their dealings with Paul, or sly and hypocritical?

Question 12: What importance does it have to Christian liberty?

- a) Christians are freed from the presence of sin.
- b) Christians can do whatever they want to do because nothing can accuse them.
- c) Christians can ignore the law of Moses because it lost its power.
- d) Christians are no longer to be bound to the law of Moses.

Question 13: Read Acts 16:1-3. Why did Paul circumcise Timothy?

Question 14: Read 1 Corinthians 9:19-23. Paul states clearly the principle he followed with Timothy and Titus. Give it in your own words.

Paul put the gospel first in everything. This principle is very important for the servant of God. He was flexible, or adaptable, to every situation so that he might find in each one an open door to preach the gospel. The important thing to him was that people were won to Christ. His own personal rights were secondary.

Question 15: Based on what you learned from question 14, explain why Paul circumcised Timothy while he rejected Titus' circumcision.

Question 16: Now you are better prepared to answer an important question. Was Paul opposed to the rite of circumcision itself? If not, what did he oppose?

B. Official Recognition Given (2:6-10)

Objective 4: State the validity of the church's recognition of a person's call and ministry.

1. Recognition of Paul's Gospel (2:6-8)

Question 17: Now let's compare Galatians 2:2 and 2:7. What did Paul set before the leaders?

Question 18: What words in verse 6 show that Paul's gospel was perfect and complete?

The result of the meeting with the leaders of the Jerusalem church was a full and glad recognition that there was only one gospel, shared alike by Jerusalem (the Jewish element) and Antioch (the Gentile element). Both Peter and Paul had their own special ministry and neither was in conflict with the other.

Question 19: How do these verses apply to church policy today? Do your church leaders examine the doctrine that workers preach or teach? Should they? Why?

Question 20: What is your opinion about fellowship among different Christian denominations that preach the true gospel of Jesus Christ?

2. Recognition of Paul as an Apostle (2:8-10)

Objective 5: Describe Paul's validity as an apostle.

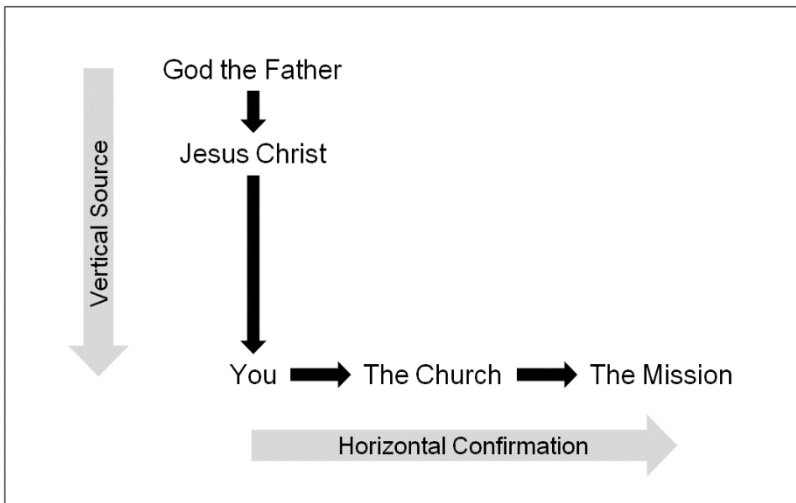
Question 21: What proof of Paul's apostleship do you see in Galatians 2:8?

Question 22: Remember that the Judaizers in Galatia were attacking both Paul's gospel and his apostleship. In view of this fact, what significance would verse 9 have for the Galatians?

- a) Probably very little.
- b) It would show that Paul was not a legalist.
- c) It would prove that Peter was an Apostle because he agreed with Paul.
- d) It would show that the church leaders in Jerusalem approved Paul's gospel and recognized his apostleship.

The ministerial requirements listed in 1 Timothy 3:1-7 also indicate the recognition of a call by the local church. In other words you are called and ordained by God, but there is also evidence in the New Testament that the divine call at some time should be confirmed by the church. The church recognizes what God has already done in the life of the one with the call.

Recognition of the Divine Call



C. Peter Corrected by Paul's Gospel (2:11-21)

Objective 6: Apply in your life and ministry the principles given in this chapter for dealing with hypocrisy and other problems.

1. Peter's Mistake and Paul's Rebuke (2:11-14)

Objective 7: Compare the problem of Jewish-Christian relations in the early church to similar problems today.

Question 23: Read Acts 10:1-11:18. With this background why was Peter's withdrawal and separation of himself from the Gentiles so bad?

- a) God had given him a revelation that Gentiles were no more unclean than Jews.
- b) He had associated with Gentiles before and had defended this position before the church in Jerusalem.
- c) His bias against Gentile believers was evident.
- d) While all things were now clean, there are some exceptions.

Actually, it was not Paul but Peter who first opened the door of God's kingdom to the Gentiles! He was the first to see the outpouring of the Holy Spirit on the Gentiles.

Question 24: Why did Peter draw back from the table? 2:12

Question 25: Compare this action of Peter's with Paul's statement about himself in Galatians 1:10.

Paul's purpose was to please _____.

Peter acted to please _____.

Hypocrisy was the nature of Peter's offense and that of those who followed him. Peter compromised his convictions. He did not act according to what he knew was right.

2. Justification by Faith without Law (2:15-18)

Question 26: Underline the word we in verses 15 and 16. What does verse 16 say that Peter and Paul knew?

Question 27: How many people can be justified by the works of the law?

Question 28: What does Paul mean in verse 17 when he says, “we too were found to be sinners”?

- a) If faith alone is not sufficient for salvation, Paul and Peter have both sinned in teaching it.
- b) Paul and Peter have both sinned because they did not teach the importance of the law.
- c) Paul and Peter have both sinned because they acted hypocritically.
- d) Paul and Peter have both sinned because they taught the importance of the law.

Question 29: In verse 18, what does Paul say that he would make himself if he went back to his position of trusting in the law for justification?

Paul is actually saying that he would be a greater sinner if he returned now to trusting in the law for salvation than he was before his conversion

3. Dead to the Law—Alive in Christ (2:19-21)

Objective 8: Quote Galatians 2:16, 20 from memory and use these key verses in your life and ministry.

The law is a source of death, not life. It condemns us to die for our sins. But Christ took our sin and guilt on himself and died in our place. As far as the law is concerned, we who are in Christ are dead. We died to the Mosaic Law and its claims on us so that we could live a new life for God.

Question 30: What are the two statements that Paul makes about the Son of God and himself at the end of Galatians 2:20?

Question 31: In 2 Corinthians 5:14-15 Paul applies this principle of divine love to those who preach the gospel. What does he say that our response to this love of Christ should be?

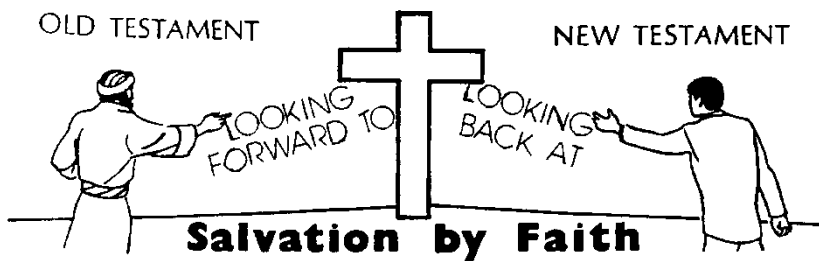
Question 32: Looking at Galatians 2:16, 21, let's restate an important point by making it into a question. Is it possible for a person to be saved by the law?

Question 33: How were people in the Old Testament saved?

Question 34: Suppose someone tells you. "I believe the good things I do will weigh more than the bad on the day of judgment. I'm trying to be good enough to go to heaven." How would you answer the person using one verse from this chapter?

STUDY PROJECT 4

1. In the early church, there were problems between Jewish and Gentile Christians. Circumcision was one of them. Can you think of a situation in your culture similar to this? Are there any problems of racism or class barriers? Do we always show the same Christian love to extremely poor people and social outcasts when some rich and influential people visit our church? List some ways in which Christian workers might act hypocritically or against their convictions for fear of what people think of them.
2. Paul refers himself in 2:20. How important do you feel that your own testimony and that of others are to encourage people in their Christian life? Write your own personal testimony.



Lesson 5

Scripture Teaches the Gospel of Faith (Galatians 3)

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. Gospel of Faith Received by Galatians (3:1-5)
- B. Gospel of Faith Given to Abraham (3:6-9)
- C. Relationship of Gospel to Law (3:10-25)
 - 1. Redemption from Curse of Law (3:10-14)
 - a. Under Curse of Law (3:10-12)
 - b. Redeemed from Curse by Christ (3:13-14)
 - 2. Promise Not Annulled by Law (3:15-18)
 - 3. Law Given to Lead Us to Christ (3:19-25)
- D. Children of God by Faith (3:26-29)

MEMORY VERSE

Galatians 3:11

LESSON OBJECTIVES

1. Appreciate Paul's firm stand on the Scriptures and the importance of this principle in your own ministry.
2. Describe the role of Abraham in the history of redemption and your relationship to him.
3. Explain what it means to be justified by faith.
4. State three important relationships between the law and the Gospel.
5. Quote from memory Galatians 3:11, state why the law of Moses cannot be basis for salvation, and explain the necessity for Christ's death on the cross.
6. State the purpose of the law and appreciate its value.
7. Outline Paul's argument for salvation by faith found in Galatians 3.
8. Describe the rights and relationships of the members of the body of Christ, appreciate them more deeply, and apply them in your life and ministry.

WORD STUDY

- *Bewitched* (3:1) – put under an evil spell or charm so they cannot act as they should.
- *The flesh* (3:3) – the physical body; sometimes translated “sinful nature.”
- *The Scripture, foreseeing* (3:8) – God's word or prophesied the blessing on Abraham's descendants because God could see what would happen in the future.
- *Blessed* (3:8) – benefited, favored. A blessing is a gift of divine favor, a means of happiness or welfare.
- *Of faith* (3:9) – used here as full of faith, believing
- *Curse* (3:10) – divine sentence of judgment and condemnation. Paul speaks of the curse as the sentence of death that God has pronounced on those who break the law.
- *Righteous* (3:11) – just, right according to God's standard and in right standing with him.
- *Redeem* (3:13) – buy back, ransom. We sell ourselves to sin and its punishment—death—when we choose to have our own way instead of obeying God. But God loved us and bought us back for himself—redeemed us—at the price of his own death. His redemptive plan is for us to be saved simply by accepting what he has done for us.
- *Covenant* (3:15) – a solemn agreement between two or more persons.
- *Intermediary* (3:19) – a middle person who brings together two parties in an agreement.
- *Put on Christ* (3:27) – put on as a garment. Brought into union with Christ we live in him.
- *Substitutionary* – in place of, as a substitute for (as Jesus' death for us)
- *Atone for* – to give satisfaction for a wrong or make amends for it. Jesus atoned for our sins by suffering the death penalty they required. This frees us from guilt. His atonement for sin is our basis of salvation.

- *Symbol* — something that stands for or represents something else. Water baptism is a symbol or picture of our union with Jesus Christ in his death and resurrection.
- *Ransom* — the price paid to free someone. Jesus' death is the ransom that sets us free from the power of sin.

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

A. Gospel of Faith Received by Galatians (3:1-5)

Objective 1: Appreciate Paul's firm stand on the Scriptures and the importance of this principle in your own ministry.

In the previous lessons Paul's argument has been based on his personal experience in the gospel. Now he turns to the Scriptures and shows that his spiritual experience is grounded on the word of God.

Question 1: Whom does Paul blame for the doctrinal error in the Galatian churches? v. 1

- a) Demonic forces
- b) The Judaizers
- c) The Galatians themselves
- d) The church in Jerusalem

Question 2: Why does Paul blame the Galatians?

Question 3: State in your own words what Paul is saying in Galatians 3:3.

Paul emphasizes here that the Christian life is supernatural from beginning to end. In verse 4 he asks the Galatians, “Did you have such wonderful spiritual experiences all for no purpose?”

Question 4: On what basis does God bless the ministry of some people today, saving many souls, pouring out his Spirit, healing the sick, or causing their churches to grow? 3:5

B. Gospel of Faith Given to Abraham (3:6-9)

Objective 2: Describe the role of Abraham in the history of redemption and your relationship to him.

Objective 3: Explain what it means to be justified by faith.

Paul now shows the Galatians that the gospel of faith they received is the same one that was given to Abraham many centuries before. Their experience was rooted in the word of God and also in the history of God's people. In his theological argument Paul shows that God's method of justifying men has always been by faith. To prove it, Paul uses Abraham as an example and quotes the good news given to him.

Question 5: Why is Abraham an appropriate example?

- a) Because he knew Jesus personally.
- b) Because he was a Gentile like the Galatians.
- c) Because he was under the law.
- d) Because he had no children at that moment.

Question 6: According to Galatians 3:6 how was Abraham made right with God? What was it that was put to his account as righteousness?

Question 7: Read Genesis 15:1-6 to acquaint you with the context of the verse that Paul quotes. Copy the verse in Genesis that Paul quotes.

Question 8: According to verse 7 who are the true descendants of Abraham?

Question 9: How does verse 8 say that God was going to justify the Gentiles?

Question 10: Who shall be blessed in Abraham? 3:8

Question 11: What is Abraham called in verse 9?

Question 12: Reading verses 8 and 9 together, who of all the nations was going to be blessed with Abraham?

In the four verses of this section (3:6-9), Paul states four times that the right relationship with God (justification, righteousness, his blessing) comes through faith. You may want to look back over these verses and underline the words “believed” and “faith.”

C. Relationship of Gospel to Law (3:10-25)

Objective 4: State three important relationships between the law and the Gospel.

1. Redemption from Curse of Law (3:10-14)

Objective 5: Quote from memory Galatians 3:11, state why the law of Moses cannot be basis for salvation, and explain the necessity for Christ's death on the cross.

The gospel is the good news of redemption on the curse that the law has pronounced on us.

a. Under Curse of Law (3:10-12)

Question 13: If a person relies on keeping the law to receive justification before God, how much of the law must the person obey? 3:10

Question 14: Read James 2:10. What is the status of the person who in all of the person's life has failed only once to keep one point of God's law?

Question 15: Now read in the law itself the verse that Paul quotes. What does Deuteronomy 27:26 say of the person who does not confirm all the words of the law by doing them?

Question 16: In Galatians 3:11 how many people does Paul say have been or can be justified by the law?

Question 17: Read Habakkuk 2:4. What part does Paul quote?

b. Redeemed from Curse by Christ (3:13-14)

Question 18: Read 1 Peter 1:18-19. What price does Peter say was paid for our redemption?

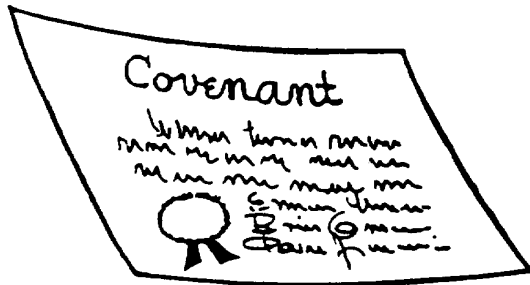
Question 19: Now compare Galatians 3:13 with 2 Corinthians 5:21. What great truth about Christ's death do you find in both of these verses?

In these two verses we have the truth that Jesus' death was substitutionary. In other words, he was our substitute and died in our place. This is how he took the curse away by becoming a curse for us.

Question 20: What two benefits does Paul say that we can receive through Christ's death for us? 3:14

2. Promise Not Annulled by Law (3:15-18)

Question 21: How many years passed between the Abrahamic covenant (Covenant of Promise given to Abraham) and the Mosaic covenant (Covenant of Law given to Moses)?



Was the promise to Abraham canceled by the giving of the law? The Judaizer might say: "All right. Abraham was justified by faith, but that was before the law was given to Moses. Your claim of salvation through faith for the Gentiles is based on the Covenant of Promise given to Abraham. Now that the Covenant of Law is in effect, the Covenant of Promise is no longer valid." Is it true?

Question 22: Now read again Galatians 3:15-18. Which verse states definitely that the law cannot cancel the promise made to Abraham?

Question 23: Read Genesis 15:9-11. In the covenant of Promise (which was before the Covenant of Law) how was the covenant of God sealed and made effective?

Therefore, we see that the Covenant of Promise given to Abraham was made effective by death. Once death has taken place, nothing can be added to the covenant.

Question 24: Remember that this is the Covenant of Promise which the Lord made for Abraham and his offspring. Who is the promised offspring of Abraham? 3:16

Question 25: You have already answered the Judaizers' question in the exercises, but let's look at it once more as we sum up this section of the lesson. Was the promise to Abraham canceled when God gave the Covenant of the Law? Why?

Question 26: Now let's apply this truth about the unchanging promise of God. What about the New Covenant? Here we refer to the New Testament—the gospel. Can it be changed or added to? Can modern Judaizers add new conditions for salvation? Think about religious groups that say, “Oh yes, Jesus is the Savior, but our founder (or prophet) came afterwards and brought us new truth about salvation.” Write here your convictions about the only requirement for salvation and how any later system of rules and requirements for salvation affect God's promise.

3. Law Given to Lead Us to Christ (3:19-25)

<i>Objective 6: State the purpose of the law and appreciate its value.</i>
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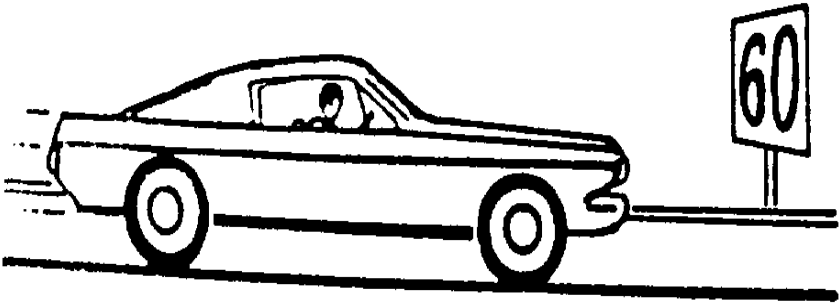
If the law was not given to justify us, why was it given? Paul deals with these questions in verses 19-24.

Question 27: Galatians 3:19 tells us why the law was given and points out its time limit. Why was it given?

Question 28: Select two possible interpretations of “because of transgressions.”

- a) For forgiveness of sin.
- b) To restrain fallen human nature.
- c) To give salvation by giving a warning.
- d) To show how Satan tempts men.
- e) To make every evil action a legal offense.

We can illustrate these two purposes of the law by a highway sign that tells drivers what the speed limit is. It restrains many motorists by reminding them of the penalty if they go over the limit. Those who exceed the speed limit are without excuse because they knowingly break the law.



Question 29: Who was the intermediary in verse 19?

Question 30: Who was the offspring in verse 19? 3:16

Question 31: The law was, therefore, to be in effect

from the time of _____

until _____ came.

In verse 21 Paul addresses another question that the Galatians or Judaizers might ask: “Is the law then contrary to the promises of God?” Maybe you have asked the same question in a different way. Was the law in conflict with the gospel of grace? Was the law a failure that had to be set aside? Did not God know that no one could keep it, that we were all too sinful to live up to its standards? Paul points out emphatically (“Certainly not!”) that God makes no mistakes. The law was not a failure that had to be discarded. It was not in conflict with the gospel. It had a definite time and place in God's redemptive plan. It served its purpose.

Question 32: Was the purpose of the law to give people salvation before Jesus came? Explain. 3:21

Question 33: Notice verses 22 and 23. What part of the Scripture is Paul talking about?

Paul points out that the purpose of the law was to show us that we were guilty of sin so that we would look for salvation and accept the Savior.

Question 34: What does Paul say the purpose was of this universal condemnation by the law? 3:22

Question 35: Verse 24 says that
the law was our _____
until _____ came,
in order that we might be _____.

The Greek word *paidagogos* translated “guardian” here might better be translated “escort.” The *paidagogos* was a servant who took care of the small children and led them from the home to the school. There he turned them over to the care of the teacher. So the law was God's servant to lead us to Christ. But now that we are in Christ's care, the escort's responsibility is finished. See verse 25.

Question 36: To sum up this section, what was the purpose of the law in God's redemptive plan?

D. Children of God by Faith (3:26-29)

Objective 7: Outline Paul's argument for salvation by faith found in Galatians 3.

Objective 8: Describe the rights and relationships of the members of the body of Christ, appreciate them more deeply, and apply them in your life and ministry.

Question 37: The title “sons of God” in Galatians 3:26 implies that a spiritual change takes place in the person who believes. According to this verse, how does a person become a child of God?

Question 38: What does Paul say in verse 27?

- a) The children of God have been changed outwardly.
- b) The children of God have a new life.
- c) We become perfect when we believe in Jesus Christ.
- d) Our past life was covered with Christ's cloth.

Question 39: Galatians 3:28 gives us the basis for the true _____ of all believers.

- a) joy
- b) honesty
- c) peace
- d) unity

Question 40: Verse 29 brings us to the climax of this chapter. If we belong to Christ and are in him, what are we?

In Christ, then, we are heirs to all the blessings promised to Abraham's offspring in the Covenant of Promise. The sole condition for receiving the blessing is to accept it in faith.

STUDY PROJECT 5

State the three main points that Paul made about the relationship between the law and the gospel by answering the following questions:

1. Why cannot the law of Moses be the basis for our salvation?
2. What effect did the law have on the promise of justification by faith given to Abraham?
3. What was the purpose of the law in God's redemptive plan?

Lesson 6

The Gospel Produces Sons—NOT Slaves

(Galatians 4)

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. From Bondage to Sonship (4:1-5)
 - 1. Bondage of Infancy (4:1-3)
 - 2. Redemption for Sonship (4:4-5)
- B. Ceremonial Religion and Spiritual Experience (4:6-11)
 - 1. Spiritual Experience of Sons (4:6-7)
 - 2. Bondage of Ceremonial Religion (4:8-11)
 - a. Ceremonial Religion
 - b. True Spirituality of the Gospel
- C. Tragedy of Return to Bondage (4:12-20)
 - 1. Glad Acceptance of the Gospel (4:12-16)
 - 2. Judaizers' Purpose and Motives (4:17-18)
 - 3. Paul's Deep Concern for the Galatians (4:19-20)
- D. Bondage or Freedom—Not Both (4:21-31)
 - 1. Allegory of the Two Covenants (4:21-27)
 - 2. Inheritance for Children of Promise (4:28-31)

LESSON OBJECTIVES

- 1. Distinguish between being a slave and a son spiritually and apply this truth in your life and ministry.
- 2. Explain the relationship of Jesus Christ to the law.
- 3. Give two important reasons why God sent his Son into the world and emphasize them in your teaching.
- 4. Compare the identifying marks of the gospel in the life of a Christian with the marks of a ceremonial religion in its followers.
- 5. Describe briefly how the Galatians received the gospel.
- 6. Contrast the motives of Paul with the motives of the Judaizers.

7. Explain the allegory of Hagar and Sarah and apply its truths to your life and ministry.

WORD STUDY

- *No different from a slave* (4:1) – A small child has no more liberty than a slave although as an heir he is master (lord).
- *Guardians and managers* (4:2) – private teachers and servants who cared for the child and saw that he did what he should.
- *Date set by his father* (4:2) – date set by the father to recognize the son as of age.
- *Elementary principles of the world* (4:3) – elementary rules, principles of the world system and rudiments of the Jewish religion. Paul points out that religious ceremonies, forms, and taboos are simple first principles and regulations. God wants us to move on into spiritual worship and real fellowship with him as grown sons.
- *Fullness of time* (4:4) – when the time appointed by God had come and all was ready.
- *Born of woman* (4:4) – referring to Jesus' humanity.
- *Adoption of sons* (4:5) – legal status of sons.
- *Abba* (4:6) – Aramaic word for father. Aramaic was the language commonly used in Jewish homes during the time of Paul.
- *Trial* (4:14) – Paul's bodily ailment.
- *Gouged out* (4:15) – taken out. They would have given Paul their own eyes.
- *Anguish* (4:19) – to suffer in giving birth. The Galatians-Paul's spiritual children
- *Change my tone* (4:20) – speak differently, not on such a painful subject or so harshly.
- *Perplexed about* (4:20) – am worried about you, don't know what to think about you.
- *Allegorically* (4:24) – like a story with an underlying meaning. Paul illustrates spiritual truths with an example from Jewish history.
- *Bearing children for slavery* (4:24) – has children who will be slaves.

- *Ceremonial* – marked by emphasis on rites and ceremonies. There are special forms, actions and words according to set patterns, that are used for certain occasion.
- *Status* – standing, rank, or position.
- *Motivation* – something that moves people to act.
- *Progressive revelation* – making known by stages.
- *External* – outside or coming from outside. Paul contrasts external motivation of the law with the internal (inside) motivation of the Spirit within us.
- *Tangible* – touchable, evident.

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

A. From Bondage to Sonship (4:1-5)

Objective 1: Distinguish between being a slave and a son spiritually and apply this truth in your life and ministry.

1. Bondage of Infancy (4:1-3)

The idea of the law as a guardian which you saw in Galatians 3:24 continues in Chapter 4. You remember that the *paidagogos* was the teacher or escort for very small children. Here we find Paul speaking of a child under guardians and managers (tutors and governors) until the child is of age. See verse 2. These guardians represent the law. Here the Jew is pictured as the young child.

Question 1: What does Paul say that this child is? 4:1

Question 2: What was the child's condition like? 4:1

Question 3: What do the guardians represent?

- a) The law
- b) The Son
- c) The Father

Verse 1 compares the child heir with slaves. If the child is the Jew, we might say that the slaves are the Gentiles in this picture.

Question 4: Compare the rights and opportunities of the child and of the slaves in verse 1.

Paul is saying here that these two groups of humanity—Jew and Gentile—were both under bondage. Both were on the same level.

Question 5: How does verse 3 describe this period of childhood under the control of guardians?

“The elementary principles of the world” is also translated as “the elemental things of the world.” This refers to basic instruction—such as teaching the alphabet. These words can include the elementary principles of the world system, ceremonial religions of both Jews and Gentiles.

2. Redemption for Sonship (4:4-5)

Objective 2: Explain the relationship of Jesus Christ to the law.

Objective 3: Give two important reasons why God sent his Son into the world and emphasize them in your teaching.

Question 6: In verse 4, who put an end to the period of the law?

Question 7: What event marked the end of the period of bondage?

Question 8: Which words in Galatians 4:4 refer to Jesus' human nature?

Question 9: Which words refer to the fact that Jesus (in his human nature) was a Jew?

Question 10: Why should Jesus be born as a Jew?

- a) Because he could ransom those who were under such conditions.
- b) Because the only way we could be free was for someone to take our place who had not broken the law.
- c) Because Jesus Christ was the only one who ever met these conditions to be our Redeemer.
- d) All of the above.

Question 11: According to verse 5, what are the two reasons why God sent his Son?

B. Ceremonial Religion and Spiritual Experience (4:6-11)

Objective 4: Compare the identifying marks of the gospel in the life of a Christian with the marks of a ceremonial religion in its followers.

1. Spiritual Experience of Sons (4:6-7)

Question 12: According to Galatians 4:6, what does God do to produce the miracle of the new birth in us?

The word *abba* is the usual name that children would use for their father in the home. This means that through the Holy Spirit we have truly become the children of God. We can go directly to him with the same confidence with which small children go to their father in the home. The Spirit himself cries out in us. “Father, Father.” In Romans 8:15 you have seen that because the Spirit of adoption is in us as we cry, “Abba, Father.”

Let's review now the differences that we have seen between the child and the grown son that Paul talks about in Galatians 4:1-7. We have listed some of them in the comparison below.

Child	Grown Son
Under Guardian (law)	Enjoys son-father relationship (redeemed)
Status: like a slave; Rights of sonship not realized	Status: son and heir; Full rights given
Under bondage: External authority of the law	Free: Internal authority of the Spirit of God
Immature: In elementary school of the law with external motivation	Mature: In secondary school of the Spirit with internal motivation

Question 13: What does each of the following represent in Paul's illustration of Galatians 4:1-7?

- a) The child
- b) The guardian
- c) The father

Question 14: What is the evidence of sonship in God's family?

2. Bondage of Ceremonial Religion (4:8-11)

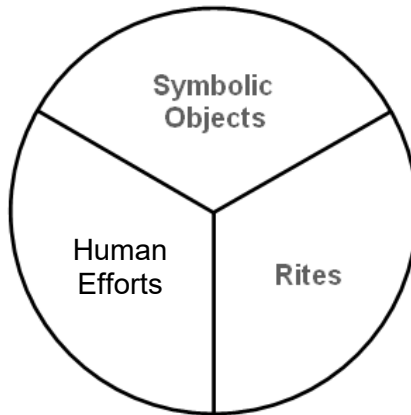
In the last analysis, the difference between the child and the grown son is the difference between ceremonial religion and the religion of spiritual experience. Paul's whole argument from theology which starts in chapter 3 is aimed at this distinction. The Galatians were going to take the backward step from spiritual experience to religious ceremony. They were going back from the gospel to Judaism. This problem is not limited to the Galatians. Many Christians today are wavering between a ceremonial religion and the religion of spiritual experience.

a. Ceremonial Religion

Question 15: What did the Galatians serve or worship before they knew God?
4:8

Idolatry is a typical ceremonial religion. We can identify ceremonial religion by the great importance it gives to:

1. Human efforts
2. Tangible things in worship
3. Rites that must be performed.



Ceremonial Religion

The Judaism of Paul's day also fit into the category of ceremonial religion. The place and prominence of men had overshadowed the true meaning and purpose of God's law.

Question 16: Name some objects used in the form of worship God required of his people under the law.

Question 17: What rite did the Judaizers insist that the Gentile Christians must observe in order to be saved?

Question 18: Why did Paul oppose circumcision for Gentile Christians? Explain.

Question 19: Name some religious rites or ceremonies that we observe in our churches.

b. True Spirituality of the Gospel

Remember that ceremonial religion gives emphasis to physical things in worship while the true spirituality of the gospel emphasizes worship in the Spirit. The emphasis of the gospel is on:

1. God's work
2. Personal knowledge of God through relationship with him
3. Worship in Spirit

Question 20: Read Acts 6:8-15 and 7:1-60. Notice the Jews' charges against Stephen. What three things did they accuse him of speaking against? 6:13-14



Religion of Spiritual Experience

Ceremonial religion was proper for the time that Israel was in the process of growth. But for those who have come into their inheritance of grown sons and have experienced the filling of the Holy Spirit, ceremonial religion would be a step backward. Those who have experienced the true spirituality of the gospel can never return to mere ceremonial religion. It would be a step from reality to ritual.

C. Tragedy of Return to Bondage (4:12-20)

1. Glad Acceptance of the Gospel (4:12-16)

Objective 5: Describe briefly how the Galatians received the gospel.



Question 21: How does Paul describe his physical condition at the time he was with the Galatians? 4:13-14

Question 22: What did Paul do in spite of his condition? 4:13

Question 23: How did they describe their condition when they received the gospel? 4:15

Question 24: Is there any lesson you can apply to your life or ministry from this story?

Objective 6: Contrast the motives of Paul with the motives of the Judaizers.

2. Judaizers' Purpose and Motives (4:17-18)

Question 25: Who are the people that Paul refers to as “they” in Galatians 4:17?

Question 26: Is Paul speaking about the Judaizers' false teaching or their motives in verse 17?

Paul says that the purpose of the Judaizers is to shut out the Galatian churches from any other influence. They wanted the Galatians to accept the law and become Jews so that they would look to the Judaizers as their spiritual leaders. They wanted the place of respect and praise among the Galatians.

3. Paul's Deep Concern for the Galatians (4:19-20)

We can see in these verses a strong contrast between the Judaizers' motives and Paul's.

Question 27: Verse 19 shows Paul's motive. Was he trying to make the Galatians depend on him or give him the first place in their affections?

Question 28: Whom did Paul want them to depend on?

Question 29: Spend some time looking at verses 19 and 20, and then list some qualifications of a good Christian leader that you see evidences of here.

D. Bondage or Freedom—Not Both (4:21-31)

1. Allegory of the Two Covenants (4:21-27)

Objective 7: Explain the allegory of Hagar and Sarah and apply its truths to your life and ministry.

Paul turns once more to the Old Testament and continues his defense of the gospel.

Question 30: Just to make sure you can identify the persons mentioned in verse 22, who were these?

- a) The two sons
- b) The slave woman
- c) The free woman

Question 31: What does Paul mean when he says that Ishmael was born “according to the flesh”? 4:23

Question 32: What contrast do you find between Ishmael and Isaac in verse 23?

Question 33: We find the main point of the allegory—the key to understanding it—in verse 24. What does Paul say that the two women represent?

Question 34: What are the two covenants that Paul talked about in Galatians 3?

- a) The Covenant of Promise given to Abraham and the New Covenant given by Jesus.
- b) The New Covenant given by Jesus and the Covenant of Law given to Moses.
- c) The Covenant of Promise given to Abraham and the Covenant of Law given to Moses.

Question 35: Which woman represents the Covenant of Law?

Question 36: What was her condition, a slave or free?

Question 37: Into what condition are all of the children of the slave woman born? 4:24-25



This allegory illustrates the two basic approaches to God that were in conflict—trust in self-efforts under the law, and faith in God's promise and the work of Christ. This was the problem of the Galatian churches and the subject of the whole epistle. When Paul says that the Jerusalem which is above is the mother of us all, he is reminding the Galatians that both Jews and Gentiles who receive Christ have a spiritual rebirth and are children of the promise.

- Question 38:** The Judaizers believed that a Gentile who accepted Christ could not become a good Christian until he had first done what?
- a) Became a good Jew.
 - b) Was baptized.
 - c) Sat daily in the temple.

2. Inheritance for Children of Promise (4:28-31)

In these verses Paul gives the conclusion of the allegory of the two covenants and its application to the Galatians.

- Question 39:** In what way are Christians and Isaac alike as children of promise? 4:28

- Question 40:** Let's apply Paul's conclusion in verse 30. What will happen to those who trust in their own goodness (or in keeping the law or the regulations of a church) to save them?

- Question 41:** Who does Paul tell the Galatian Christians that they are? 4:31

- Question 42:** Now compare Galatians 4:31 with verse 21. What step were the Galatians considering?

- Question 43:** If they did this, whose children would they become?

Question 44: What would happen then to their inheritance?

Perhaps you can understand better now Paul's travail of spirit in verse 19. Perhaps you would like to pray for Christians who are in a spiritual conflict now between faith and legalism.

STUDY PROJECT 6

Give your own opinion as to what churches today might become guilty of mere ceremonial religion without real spiritual experience. Include various forms of bondage that Christian churches have imposed on their members.

Lesson 7

The Gospel Stands the Test of Life (Galatians 5-6)

LESSON OUTLINE

- A. Results of Works and of Faith (5:1-26)
 - 1. Circumcision or Faith (5:1-6)
 - 2. Progress Hindered by Legalism (5:7-12)
 - 3. Law Fulfilled by Love (5:13-15)
 - 4. Conflict of Flesh and Spirit (5:16-18)
 - 5. Failure of Human Efforts (5:19-21)
 - 6. Triumph of Life in the Spirit (5:22-26)
- B. Gospel Applied to Daily Life (6:1-18)
 - 1. Guidance for Personal Relations (6:1-6)
 - 2. Decision in View of Results (6:7-10)
 - 3. Conclusion: New Life in Christ (6:11-18)

MEMORY VERSE Galatians 5:22-23

LESSON OBJECTIVES

- 1. Give Paul's main objection to the Judaizers' insistence on circumcision.
- 2. Point out the difference between the relationship of circumcision to Abraham's faith and its relationship to the faith of the Galatians.
- 3. Explain the part that love has in overcoming the works of the flesh and apply this in your own life and ministry.
- 4. State the role of the Holy Spirit in the believer's war against the flesh.
- 5. Contrast the works of the flesh with the fruit of the Spirit.
- 6. Apply some instructions from the passage to your life.
- 7. State how the principle of the harvest applies to the present and the future and apply this principle in your life and teaching.

WORD STUDY

- *Submit...to a yoke* (5:1) – caught in or snared by the yoke of slavery. The yoke on the neck of oxen or other animals to hitch them to a plow or cart is symbol of slavery.
- *No advantage to you* (5:2) – would not do you any good.
- *Testify* (5:3) – to make an official statement as a witness.
- *Fallen away from grace* (5:4) – no longer trusting in grace (the undeserved favor of God) and so fallen from that state in grace. Instead of progressing they had fallen from grace into law.
- *Counts for* (5:6) – accomplishes, is of use.
- *Persuasion* (5:8) – the way in which they had been led away from their faith to another belief.
- *Leaven* (5:9) – yeast. A little bit of yeast makes the whole mass of dough (lump) light.
- *Opportunity for the flesh* (5:13) – opportunity to let your physical desires or sinful human nature have their way.
- *Bite and devour...consumed* (5:15) – if you act like cannibals or animals fighting and eating one another, be careful or you will completely destroy one another.
- *Desires of the flesh* (5:16) – strong desires of your lower nature.
- *Evident* (5:19) – visible, evident, clearly seen.
- *Works of the flesh* (5:19) – what human nature does, actions that come from our sinful nature and own self effort.
- *Sexual immorality, impurity* (5:19) – sexual immorality and impurity both refer to unlawful sex relations especially among unmarried persons.
- *Sensuality* (5:19) – refers to obscene words, thoughts, and actions as well as to physical uncleanness.
- *Strife* (5:20) – quarreling or arguing.
- *Jealousy* (5:20) – rivalry or trying to equal or surpass others.
- *Fits of anger* (5:20) – strong anger.
- *Dissensions* (5:20) – fighting.

- *Divisions* (5:20) - stirring up rebellion against authority.
- *Gentleness* (5:23) – mildness, meekness, patience.
- *Restore* (6:1) – bring back to his place in Christ and in their fellowship.
- *Burdens* (6:2) – loads, problems that weigh a person down.
- *Test his own work* (6:4) – test what he does.
- *Mocked* (6:7) – made fool of, outwitted.
- *Whatever one sows, that will he also reap* (6:7) – what he plants he harvests.
- *Corruption* (6:8) – physical decay and suffering in this life and in the world to come.
- *New creation* (6:15) – new person.
- *Marks of Jesus* (6:17) – brand marks of ownership.

LESSON DEVELOPMENT

A. Results of Works and of Faith (5:1-26)

1. Circumcision or Faith (5:1-6)

Objective 1: Give Paul's main objection to the Judaizers' insistence on circumcision.

Objective 2: Point out the difference between the relationship of circumcision to Abraham's faith and its relationship to the faith of the Galatians.

- Question 1:** What do you think Paul means by “submit again to a yoke of slavery?”
- a) They would be placing themselves under bondage to the law.
 - b) They would be under God's wrath once more.
 - c) They would no longer be trusting in Christ alone to save them.
 - d) They would never have a chance to be saved.

Question 2: Remember that the Judaizers' error was that they wanted to add something to the redemptive work of Christ as a requirement for salvation. What rite did they say was necessary?

Question 3: We have already seen that Paul was not against circumcision in itself but he was against circumcision as being necessary for

Question 4: What would happen to the Galatians relationship with Christ if they were circumcised? 5:2

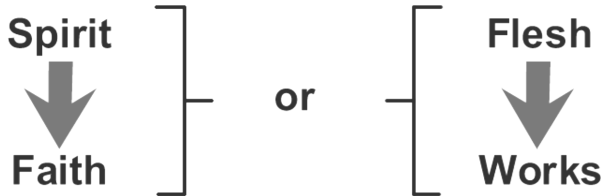
Paul considered that the sufficiency of Christ's work was being challenged. Does verse 2 apply to us today? We can restate it in a positive way: Christ is an advantage to those who trust in him alone for salvation, but if we try to add anything else as a basis for salvation such as water baptism, keeping the Sabbath, or any rules of conduct, Christ will profit us nothing. By adding these to Christ's redemptive work we are saying that his death was not enough to save us, that something else is needed.

Question 5: According to Galatians 5:3 under what obligation would the Galatians put themselves if they accepted the rite of circumcision?

Question 6: How does Paul describe the state of those who have known Christ, but look to a system of rules as a basis of their standing before God? 5:4

Question 7: In Galatians 5:5 what are the two means by which we wait for the hope of righteousness?

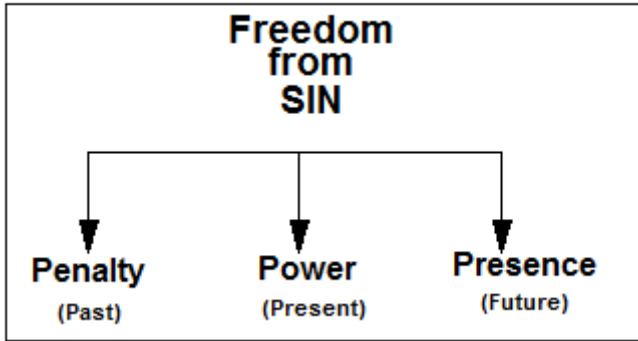
The Judaizers' hope of righteousness was just the opposite of “through the Spirit, by faith.” Theirs was through circumcision (through the physical body), by the law (their own works).



Galatians 5:6 is the key verse to this section. Paul anticipates this argument from the Judaizers: “If people do not follow the law, their conduct will be immoral. Preaching salvation by faith alone causes people to neglect their moral conduct.”

Galatians 5:5-6 mentions two parts of Paul's answer to this argument of the legalists. They are the Spirit (v. 5) and love (v. 6). First, the Judaizers did not take into consideration that the people justified by faith experiences an inner transformation. This change in the their inner beings are brought about by the power of the Holy Spirit. Not only does the Spirit produce an inner transformation but he is also an inner source of strength to help the believers live a moral life. This advantage is only in Christ (v. 6). This is the basis of the moral argument

Second, Paul says that faith operates by the principle of love. The people of faith are not free to do anything they please. The love mentioned here is divine love. It is the kind of love that God has. When God comes into the life of believers the love of God is also present (Romans 5:5). Those who live by faith are to be directed in their conduct by the principle of love. They experience this love for God and for others as the fruit of the Spirit living in them. This is the goal of the gospel—a life lived by faith in Christ and guided by the principle of divine love.



Question 8: What two guides do the believers have to direct and help them in their moral conduct?

Question 9: How does the Holy Spirit lead the believers to live a moral life?

- a) The Holy Spirit forces them to live a moral life regardless of their own will.
- b) The Holy Spirit transforms them inwardly and becomes an inner source of strength to help them to live a moral life.
- c) The Holy Spirit reminds them the punishment of an immoral life.
- d) The Holy Spirit frees them from the presence of sin to live a moral life.

Question 10: Which words best describe divine love?

- a) Self-love
- b) Sacrificial love.
- c) Free love.
- d) Deep affection.

Question 11: Write down your own idea how divine love is expressed in a believer's life.

Question 12: Reflect on the illustration of the speed limit and the safe driver. Which would be more effective in governing a person's conduct, a complete list of regulations for a holy life or the Holy Spirit filling a person with divine love?

2. Progress Hindered by Legalism (5:7-12)

Question 13: What does Paul say about the progress of the Galatians while they were following the gospel of faith in Christ? 5:7

Question 14: What kind of effect did the Judaizers' message have on them? 5:7

Question 15: Who or what is represented by the leaven? 5:9

Question 16: What lesson about the danger of "leaven" in our churches can we learn from verse 9? What does this imply that we should do about it? Matthew 16:11-12.

Question 17: We can learn a very important Christian attitude from verse 11. What is it?

In Galatians 5:11 Paul refers to the persecution that he suffered because he no longer preached circumcision. It is possible that the Judaizers were telling the Galatians that Paul also preached the necessity of circumcision.

Paul says that if that were so he would avoid the persecution and charges of the Judaizers wherever he went. But they were continually fighting and accusing him. Paul says, “This is proof that I am preaching the same gospel wherever I go; look at the reaction of these Judaizers that reject the cross of Christ!”

Question 18: How does Paul refer to the Judaizers in 5:12?

Question 19: Now look at Paul's strong words about the Judaizers in 5:10, 12; 1:8-9. Compare these with Matthew 18:6. Why do you suppose Paul opposed the Judaizers so strongly and even called for God to judge them?

3. Law Fulfilled by Love (5:13-15)

Objective 3: Explain the part that love has in overcoming the works of the flesh and apply this in your own life and ministry.

Question 20: In verse 13, Paul gives two guidelines, one positive and the other negative, within which we can freely choose our course of action. What are they?

Negative:

Positive:

Question 21: Sum up in one word the “law” which is to control and guide the Christian's conduct. 5:14

In verse 14, Paul states that this divine love is the fulfillment of the whole law. What a surprise! Those who give up trying to keep the law and turn from it to Christ find that his love controlling their lives leads them to do

joyfully and naturally what they could not do before. They are fulfilling the whole law! We see then that the gospel meets the test of life by the transforming power of divine love. It results in a life of holiness which the law could not produce.

4. Conflict of Flesh and Spirit (5:16-18)

Question 22: Notice the very important secret of victory over sin in verse 16. What does Paul tell the Galatians to do?

Question 23: What similar phrase do you find in verse 18?

Question 24: What does Paul describe the inner battle in the Christian?

- a) Law and grace
- b) Love and hate
- c) Flesh and Spirit
- d) Knowledge and will

Question 25: Explain what it means to “walk by the Spirit.”

5. Failure of Human Efforts (5:19-21)

Remember that Paul's argument in this chapter is to show by the results which is right—faith or works, the gospel or law. He has shown that in the gospel of faith we are transformed by God's love and led by his Spirit in such a way that we meet the standard of holiness that he has set for us. Now, by contrast, we see that trusting in our own efforts to be holy brings defeat. Why? Because our flesh is stronger than our desire to please God. We depend on ourselves and experience the natural results of living according to the flesh. Paul warns the Galatians, “Depend on your own efforts to live right and these will be the results.”

Question 26: List as many works of the flesh as possible on a blackboard. You can think of the works of the flesh in your society or self. You can find some from verses 5:19-21, but they are not the full list. You will use this list in Question 29.

Question 27: What will happen to those who practice the works of the flesh?
5:21

Question 28: Does Paul say that our salvation relies on our works in verse 21? Explain.

6. Triumph of Life in the Spirit (5:22-26)

Objective 4: State the role of the Holy Spirit in the believer's war against the flesh.

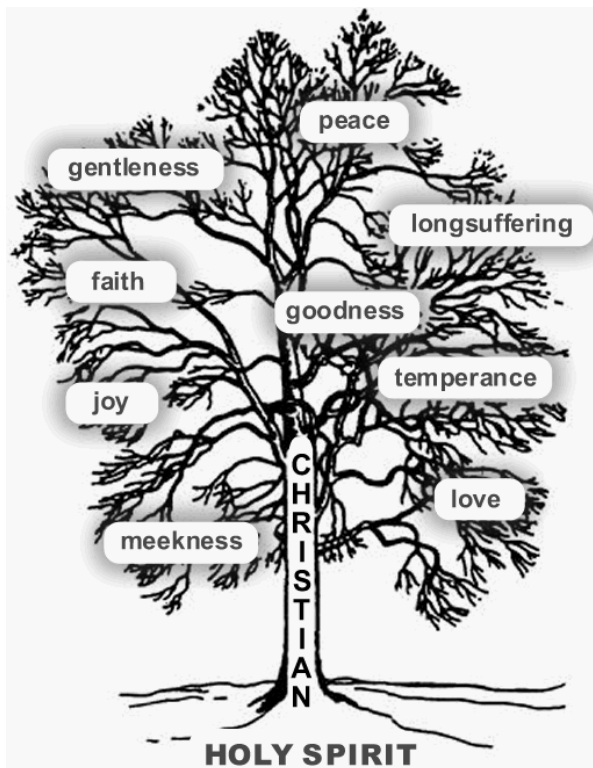
Objective 5: Contrast the works of the flesh with the fruit of the Spirit.

Question 29: Paul has given us a list of the deeds of the flesh. Now he gives us a corresponding list of the fruit of the Spirit. Notice the words deeds (or works) and fruit. Choose a right comparison between “deeds” and “fruit.”

- a) “Fruit” is a product of the will, choice, or efforts of men, while “deeds” are the spontaneous product of the Spirit of Christ within the Christian.
- b) “Deeds” are a product of the will, choice, or efforts of men, while “fruit” is the spontaneous product of the Spirit of Christ within the Christian.
- c) Both “deeds” and “fruit” are a product of the will, choice, or efforts of men.
- d) Both “deeds” and “fruit” are the spontaneous product of the Spirit of Christ within the Christian.

Question 30: Now go back to the list you made in Question 25. Then let the group suggest which fruits of the Spirit will cancel out each of the works of the flesh. Let them write these qualities beside the corresponding work of the flesh, repeating whenever necessary. Remember that faith refers to faith in God and his Word. This leads to obedience.

Question 31: According to Galatians 5:24, what has the Christian done that results in his freedom from the law and makes it possible for him to produce the fruit of the Spirit?



Question 32: Choose a wrong interpretation of verse 25.

- a) Since you have divine resources available, use them!
- b) Depend upon the Holy Spirit for the power to live a Christ-like life.
- c) You have been saved by the work of the Holy Spirit, depend upon your power to walk in the way of the Holy Spirit.
- d) By faith yield yourself to the Holy Spirit within you and allow him to order your conduct.

Question 33: What causes the fruit of the Spirit to appear in the life of a Christian?

- a) His determination to produce it.
- b) His efforts to keep God's laws.
- c) The presence of the Holy Spirit.
- d) Water baptism and church membership.

Question 34: How can the believer make use of this power to help him?

B. Gospel Applied to Daily Life (6:1-18)

1. Guidance for Personal Relations (6:1-6)

<i>Objective 6: Apply some instructions from the passage to your life.</i>
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Question 35: The followings are some applications we can learn from Galatians 6:1-6. Write down the corresponding verse to each application.

- a) _____ A believer should take care of the sick.
- b) _____ Church discipline should be done with a spirit of gentleness.
- c) _____ We would better understand our position before God.
- d) _____ Church discipline should be done by a spiritual brother or sister.
- e) _____ We should help the needy in the church.
- f) _____ We should not be proud of ourselves.

- g) _____ Nobody can be confident of being tempted.
- h) _____ The purpose of church discipline is restoration.
- i) _____ When we minister, we should seek the power and wisdom from God.
- j) _____ Congregation should support the workers of God.
- k) _____ We need to take care of sin in the church
- l) _____ We need to complete our responsibility.

How does the “burden” of verse 2 differ from the “load” of verse 5? It looks like these two verses contradict one another. The one in verse 2 refers to a heavy load requiring help. The word used in verse 5 refers to a lighter load that a person would be expected to carry without the help of others.

2. Decision in View of Results (6:7-10)

Objective 7: State how the principle of the harvest applies to the present and the future and apply this principle in your life and teaching.

Question 36: Read verse 8. Would the Judaizers and those who followed them be depending on the flesh (human nature) or on the Spirit in their daily conduct?

Question 37: What will people reap who depend on their own efforts to be good, or who let their own desires rule their lives? 6:8

Galatians 6:7-9



Question 38: What will the person reap who lives by the Spirit as his source of righteousness?

Remember that the Galatians had started their Christian life “in the Spirit.” Paul encourages them in verse 9 not to be weary or tired of such a life with all of the responsibilities that it includes. Looking toward the harvest helps give us the strength for the planting and cultivating that must be done.

Question 39: To which two groups do we have the duty of doing good as we have opportunity? 6:10

3. Conclusion: New Life in Christ (6:11-18)

Objective 8: State the rule that summarizes Paul's practical argument and apply the rule to a given situation.

Question 40: Paul points out in verse 12 two motives of the Judaizers in trying to get the Galatians to be circumcised and become Jews. Explain them.

Question 41: According to verse 14, what is Paul proud of?

- a) The number of his converts.
- b) The position he holds as the apostle to the Gentiles.
- c) The sufficiency of Christ's work on the cross.
- d) His sufferings because of preaching the message of the cross.

Galatians 6:15 is the central truth and the summary of the whole moral argument. How can a person live a life that pleases God? Does circumcision produce such a life? No! Does uncircumcision? No! What does? A new creation! And this is what the gospel produces. Everyone

who is in Christ is a new creation, a new person with the Holy Spirit living in the person and giving him/her the power to live the kind of life that God wants.

Question 42: What is the important truth you can find from verse 15, regarding the believers?

Question 43: You can see, in verse 15, a contrast between the messages preached by Christ and by the Judaizers. Which message produces a new creation?

- a) The message of ceremonial religion.
- b) The message of faith in Christ.
- c) The message of keeping the law.
- d) The message of imitating Christ's example.

Question 44: What does Paul call the marks from his persecution for Christ? 6:17

Now notice in the last verse that Paul does not hesitate to call the Galatians “brothers.” He prays for divine grace to be theirs: grace—often defined simply but beautifully as God's unmerited favor toward people; grace—received not on the basis of our own works but on the basis of God's love and mercy; grace—the means through which we are saved or justified by faith! Ephesians 2:8-9.

STUDY PROJECT 7

Write a sermon with the title of “the Sufficiency of the Gospel.” Take any passage from the Book of Galatians to develop this sermon.



Unit Exam 2

Part 1 - If the statement is true, circle T, if false, circle F.

1. T/F Paul was against circumcision itself.
2. T/F Paul was ready to adjust himself at any time for the sake of the gospel.
3. T/F People in the Old Testament were saved by keeping the law.
4. T/F A direct revelation is more spiritual than an indirect revelation.
5. T/F The Judaizers' motive was good but their teaching was wrong.
6. T/F Paul circumcised Timothy because other apostles asked to do so.
7. T/F We should do good to the believers more than to the unbelievers.
8. T/F A person can be saved if the person believes in his/her religion sincerely.
9. T/F The purpose of church discipline is to punish the sinner.

Part 2 – Short answer.

10. If a person relies on keeping the law for the person's salvation, how much of the law should he keep?
11. Whom did Paul blame for the doctrinal wavering and inconsistency of the Galatians?
- 12-15. Name four ways in which Christians may be guided by the Holy Spirit.

Part 3 - Mark ONE correct answer.

16. What is the basis of Paul's theological argument in Galatians 3?
 - a) The theology presented in the Gospels.
 - b) The Old Testament Scriptures.
 - c) The rabbinical teaching of Gamaliel.
 - d) The decree of the Council at Jerusalem.
17. Why is Abraham an appropriate example?
 - a) Because he knew Jesus personally.
 - b) Because he was a Gentile like the Galatians.
 - c) Because he was under the law.
 - d) Because he had no children at that moment.
18. What work of the law was Paul referring to when he said the law was our schoolmaster?
 - a) Its standards of right and wrong showed us how to please God.
 - b) It taught us the basic principles for good relationships with manhood and God.
 - c) It showed us what sinners we were and how much we needed a Savior.
 - d) It showed us that God blesses those who keep his commandments.
19. What was Paul's purpose in presenting his gospel to the leaders of the Jerusalem church?
 - a) to find out if his message was all right.
 - b) to have their approval and backing in his missionary work.
 - c) to please the Judaizers.
 - d) to prevent misunderstandings between Jewish Church in Jerusalem and Gentile Church.
20. Which method of guidance does God use most often with his children?
 - a) Visions
 - b) Prophecies
 - c) Group consultation
 - d) The Bible
21. Select a correct explanation regarding the law.

- a) The law is spiritual because it can give us salvation.
 - b) The law is spiritual although it cannot give us salvation.
 - c) The law is not spiritual because it cannot give us salvation.
 - d) The law is not spiritual although it can give us salvation.
22. What did Paul tell the Galatians they would have to do if they were circumcised?
- a) They would have to keep the Sabbath too.
 - b) They would have to study the law.
 - c) They would have to attend the synagogue.
 - d) They would have to keep all of the law.
23. What is the main point illustrated in the allegory of Hagar and Sarah?
- a) There is a conflict between legalism and faith.
 - b) The law brings bondage, not freedom.
 - c) What we are affects our children.
 - d) The messianic line was through Sarah.
24. What was Paul's condition when he first preached the gospel to the Galatians?
- a) He was suffering physically.
 - b) He was enjoying excellent health.
 - c) He was admired for his strength.
 - d) He was afraid he would be persecuted.
25. What was Jesus' relationship to the law?
- a) He was subject to it and fulfilled it.
 - b) He taught against it.
 - c) He taught it as the way of salvation.
 - d) He was indifferent to its claims.
26. Peter's faults in Galatians 2 could best be described as . . .
- a) lying and swearing.
 - b) hypocrisy and compromise.
 - c) pride and racism.
 - d) cowardice and lack of faith.
27. What was the purpose of the command for the Jews to be circumcised?
- a) To remind them that they had to keep all of the law.

- b) To save them through their obedience.
 - c) To show that they accepted the law.
 - d) To remind them they were under the covenant God made with Abraham.
28. How are the Covenant of Promise and the law related?
- a) The covenant was not affected by the giving of the law.
 - b) The law temporarily suspended the Covenant of Promise.
 - c) The law and the Covenant were both ways of attaining God's righteousness.
 - d) The law was given because the Covenant had failed.
29. Which is the best definition of redeem?
- a) To save from sin.
 - b) To heal the sickness of the soul.
 - c) To buy for a certain price. To pay a ransom.
 - d) To receive a gift.
30. What is meant by the fruit of the Spirit?
- a) The result of our efforts to do what the Spirit wants us to do.
 - b) The result of our suppressing the desires of our flesh and cultivating the higher nature of our spirit.
 - c) The result of the presence of the Holy Spirit in us giving us a new nature.
 - d) The power that comes from the experience of the baptism in the Holy Spirit.
31. Five of the qualities that Paul lists as the fruit of the Spirit in Galatians are
- a) gentleness, faith, peace, love, joy.
 - b) faith, perseverance, love, hope, joy.
 - c) longsuffering, love, truth, peace, joy.
 - d) love, peace, joy, faith, hope.
32. The basic error of the Judaizers in the Galatian churches was that they . . .
- a) ignored completely Christ's work.
 - b) added something to Christ's work.
 - c) substituted something for Christ's work.
 - d) took something away from Christ's work.

33. Why did Paul refuse to let Titus be circumcised?
- a) He was against circumcision.
 - b) Titus was too old to be circumcised.
 - c) Circumcision was only for Jews.
 - d) He didn't want to compromise with the Judaizers.
34. The leaders of the Jerusalem church were . . .
- a) Peter, James the Lord's brother, John.
 - b) Peter, James the Apostle, John.
 - c) Peter, James the Apostle, Philip.
 - d) Peter, John, Philip.
35. In Galatians 4 Paul compares the person under the law to
- a) a small child under guardians and managers until he receives the freedom of a grown son.
 - b) a grown son who is treated no better than a slave.
 - c) a slave who will be adopted as a son.
 - d) a son who should demand his rights.
36. Paul says we can receive the blessings God promised Abraham and his seed if we are
- a) his natural descendants through Isaac or any of his other sons.
 - b) Jews
 - c) Jews who keep their faith in God.
 - d) Jews or Gentiles who are in Christ.
37. Paul pointed out to the Galatians that they had started their Christian life by
- a) trusting in the law and should now put their trust in Christ.
 - b) receiving the Holy Spirit by faith and they should continue in the same way.
 - c) receiving the Holy Spirit and they should now perfect themselves by following a standard of righteousness.
 - d) trusting in the Spirit until they could learn the law and could follow it.
38. What is the main reason why the law of Moses cannot be the basis for salvation?
- a) It includes too many rules for anyone to remember them all.

- b) The problems of our modern culture are different from those in Moses' time.
- c) No one except Christ has ever been able to obey all of its commands.
- d) It was only for the Jews.

Part 4

- 39-44. List three contrasts between the emphases in ceremonial religion and spiritual experience.
45. Explain the principle Paul applied to Timothy's circumcision and rejecting Titus' circumcision.

Write down the following verses from your memory:

46-48. Galatians 2:20

49-50. Galatians 3:11